Increasing ratios in finite nonnegative linearization

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Abstract. For finite stochastic three-term recurrences, the companion paper [1] proves nonnegative linearization (property (P)) when the ratio of the diagonal to the downward coefficients is constant and the Newton coefficients of the profile $d_i = b_i + c_i$ are log-concave without internal zeros. We admit ratios $\rho(i) = c_i/d_i$ that increase with the index. Property (P) holds when the Newton coefficients of b are those of c times nonincreasing weights. On profiles with log-concave Newton coefficients and nondecreasing b it holds when ρ is linear or a convex quadratic in the index, when the Newton coefficients of ρ are nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros, in any degree, and for cubic ratios $r + tx + \tau\binom{x}{2} + \sigma\binom{x}{3}$ under the single inequality $r\sigma \le \frac{7}{4}t\tau$. On profiles of Newton degree at most two, ratios of any degree are admitted when the Newton coefficients of c are log-concave. The proofs resum the moves of a kernel recurrence; the key inequalities for log-concave and cubic ratios are proved with exact computer certificates. A self-contained proof that log-concavity of Newton coefficients is preserved under pointwise products (Walkup's theorem) is included. Nondecreasing b alone, or nonnegative Newton coefficients of the ratio alone, do not suffice.

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1. Introduction

Szwarc [3, §5, Problem 2] asked for criteria, in the recurrence coefficients, for nonnegative linearization (property (P)) of finite systems of orthogonal polynomials. The companion paper [1] answers this for arrays whose diagonal and downward coefficients have a constant ratio: property (P) holds whenever the Newton coefficients of the profile are log-concave without internal zeros. This paper treats ratios $\rho(i) = c_i/(b_i + c_i)$ that increase with i.

Section 2 recalls the setting and the log-concavity inequality on which all proofs rest. Section 3 extends the kernel recurrence of [1] to arrays with independent diagonal and downward coefficients and proves property (P) when the Newton coefficients of b are those of c times nonincreasing weights (Theorem 3.1 and Corollary 3.2), and for arrays that are quadratic in the index (Proposition 3.3). In general some moves of the recurrence have negative weight; Section 4 handles them by a resummation, for ratios that increase linearly

(Theorem 4.1) or as a convex quadratic (Theorem 4.2) on every log-concave Newton profile, under the natural condition that b be nondecreasing. Section 5 treats ratios of higher degree: on profiles of Newton degree at most two (Theorem 5.1), and on every log-concave Newton profile when the Newton coefficients of the ratio are log-concave (Theorem 5.5) or, for cubic ratios, when $r\sigma \le t\tau$ (Theorem 5.6). Proposition 5.3, due to Walkup [4], shows that log-concavity of Newton coefficients is preserved under pointwise products. Section 6 records counterexamples and open problems.

The key inequalities of Theorems 5.5 and 5.6 are proved with exact computer certificates; the other numbered results have written proofs and are formalized in Lean 4 (see the section on code and formalization).

2. Setting

We use the conventions of [1]. An array of real coefficients $(a_i, b_i, c_i)_{0\le i\le N}$ satisfies

$$\begin{gathered} a_0 = 1, \quad b_0 = c_0 = 0, \quad a_N = 0, \quad a_i + b_i + c_i = 1, \\ a_i > 0 \ (i < N), \qquad c_i > 0 \ (i > 0), \end{gathered} \tag{2.1}$$

and $R_{-1} = 0$, $R_0 = 1$ and $xR_i = a_iR_{i+1} + b_iR_i + c_iR_{i-1}$ $(0 \le i < N)$ define its polynomials, with $R_i(1) = 1$. By [1, Lemma 2.1] the array has a positive orthogonality measure on $N+1$ real points, which include 1, and on this support $R_mR_n = \sum_k g(m,n;k)R_k$ with $g(m,n;k) = [R_m(J)]_{n,k}$, where J is the tridiagonal recurrence matrix; the array has *nonnegative linearization*, or *property (P)*, if all $g(m,n;k) \ge 0$. We write $d_i = b_i + c_i$ for the profile and, for $i \ge 1$, $\rho(i) = c_i/d_i$ for the ratio.

The Newton coefficients of a sequence $(u_i)_{0\le i\le N}$ are $\Delta^k u(0) = \sum_{i\le k}(-1)^{k-i}\binom{k}{i}u_i$, so that $u_n = \sum_k \binom{n}{k}\Delta^k u(0)$. A nonnegative, finitely supported sequence $(u_k)_{k\ge0}$ is *log-concave without internal zeros* if its positive entries form an interval and $u_k^2 \ge u_{k-1}u_{k+1}$ for all $k \ge 1$. For such a sequence put $f_n(\ell) = \sum_{h\ge0}\binom{\ell}{h}u_{n+h}$, and, for integers $p, q \ge 0$,

$$W_{p,q}(\ell, a) = \sum_{n\ge p} \binom{n-p+q}{q}\binom{a}{n} f_n(\ell),$$

with $A_j = W_{2j+1,j}$, $B_j = W_{2j+2,j}$ and $C_j = W_{2j+2,j+1}$ when these are formed from the Newton coefficients of the profile.

Lemma 2.1 *([1]).* *Let $(u_k)_{k\ge0}$ be nonnegative, finitely supported and log-concave without internal zeros. Then $(u_k + u_{k+1})_{k\ge0}$ has the same property, hence so does $(f_n(\ell))_{n\ge0}$ for every $\ell \ge 0$, and*

$$f_i(\ell)\, f_l(\ell+1) \ge f_0(\ell+1)\, f_{i+l}(\ell) \qquad (i, l \ge 1,\ \ell \ge 0).$$

Proof. For a nonnegative finitely supported sequence u that is log-concave without internal zeros, $v_i = u_i + u_{i+1}$ has the same property, since $v_i^2 - v_{i-1}v_{i+1} = (u_i^2 - u_{i-1}u_{i+1}) + (u_{i+1}^2 - u_iu_{i+2}) + (u_iu_{i+1} - u_{i-1}u_{i+2})$ and the last term is nonnegative by log-concavity. The sequence $(f_n(\ell))_n$ is obtained from $(u_n)_n$ by applying $u \mapsto v$ ℓ times. For such a

sequence g, balanced products dominate: $g_i g_l \geq g_0 g_{i+l}$ and $g_i g_{l+1} \geq g_1 g_{i+l}$ for $i, l \geq 1$. Adding these with $g = f(\ell)$ and using $g_l + g_{l+1} = f_l(\ell+1)$ and $g_0 + g_1 = f_0(\ell+1)$ gives the claim. ∎

For the profile, with $u_k = \nu_k$ and $\nu_0 = 0$, one has $f_0(\ell) = d_\ell$, and the inequality reads $f_i(\ell) f_l(\ell+1) \geq d_{\ell+1} f_{i+l}(\ell)$. The paper [1] proves property (P) for constant ratios by expanding the product coefficients in a kernel $\omega_{\ell,a}$ on $\Omega = \{(\ell, a) : \ell, a \geq 0,\ \ell + a \leq N\}$, which satisfies a recurrence in ℓ whose moves have weights formed from the $W_{p,q}$, and by matching each move of odd index with two-step detours through moves of even index [1, Lemmas 3.2 and 3.4]. We extend that argument.

3. Ratios given by weights

The kernel argument also works in the stochastic normalization itself, with independent diagonal and downward coefficients. Let $a_i + b_i + c_i = 1$ for $0 \leq i \leq N$, with $b_0 = c_0 = 0$, $a_N = 0$, $a_i > 0$ for $i < N$ and $c_i > 0$ for $i \geq 1$. Write

$$\kappa_k = \sum_{i=0}^{k} (-1)^{k-i} \binom{k}{i} c_i, \qquad \beta_k = \sum_{i=0}^{k} (-1)^{k-i} \binom{k}{i} b_i \qquad (1 \leq k \leq N),$$

with $\kappa_k = \beta_k = 0$ for $k = 0$ and $k > N$, and put $\varphi_n(\ell) = \sum_{h \geq 0} \binom{\ell}{h} \kappa_{n+h}$ and $\psi_n(\ell) = \sum_{h \geq 0} \binom{\ell}{h} \beta_{n+h}$, so that $\varphi_0(\ell) = c_\ell$ and $\psi_0(\ell) = b_\ell$ for $\ell \leq N$.

Theorem 3.1 *(Varying ratio).* *Let (κ_k) be log-concave without internal zeros and $\beta_k \geq 0$ for all k. Suppose that for $0 \leq \ell \leq N-1$*

$$\psi_1(\ell)\, \varphi_n(\ell+1) \geq c_{\ell+1}\, \psi_{n+1}(\ell) \quad (n \geq 2), \qquad \varphi_2(\ell)\, \psi_n(\ell+1) \geq c_{\ell+1}\, \psi_{n+2}(\ell) \quad (n \geq 1).$$

Then the system has nonnegative linearization.

Corollary 3.2. *If (κ_k) is log-concave without internal zeros and $\beta_k = w_k \kappa_k$ for $k \geq 1$ with $w_1 \geq w_2 \geq \cdots \geq 0$, then the system has nonnegative linearization. The ratio $c_i/(b_i + c_i)$ is nondecreasing in $i \geq 1$, and it is constant when w is constant on the support of κ; these are the arrays of [1, Theorem 3.1].*

For example, if c is a convex quadratic in i ($\kappa_1, \kappa_2 > 0$, $\kappa_k = 0$ for $k \geq 3$) and $b_i = w_1 \kappa_1 i + w_2 \kappa_2 \binom{i}{2}$ with $w_1 > w_2 \geq 0$, scaled so that $b_N + c_N = 1$, the ratio $c_i/(b_i + c_i)$ increases strictly. The hypotheses exclude the counterexample recorded in Section 6, whose diagonal coefficients $b = (0, 1, 1, 1)/91$ have Newton coefficients of both signs. They also exclude strictly increasing linear ratios $c_i/(b_i + c_i)$ with a linear profile, whose diagonal coefficients are concave; Proposition 3.3 below covers these.

Proof of Theorem 3.1. Put $e_i = \prod_{j<i} a_j / c_{j+1}$ and $E_i = e_i R_i$. Then $x E_i = c_{i+1} E_{i+1} + b_i E_i + a_{i-1} E_{i-1}$ on the support. The out-of-range terms are omitted: at the endpoints, $x E_0 = c_1 E_1$ and $x E_N = b_N E_N + a_{N-1} E_{N-1}$. The series $F = \sum_i E_i z^i$ satisfies $xF = \mathcal{L}_z F$ with

$$\mathcal{L}_z = z^{-1} c(\theta_z) + b(\theta_z) + z\big(1 - b(\theta_z) - c(\theta_z)\big),$$

where $c(\theta) = \sum_k \kappa_k \binom{\theta}{k}$ and $b(\theta) = \sum_k \beta_k \binom{\theta}{k}$. As in [1, Section 3], $K_k = \sum_{m,n} L^k_{mn} z^m w^n$, with $E_m E_n = \sum_k L^k_{mn} E_k$, satisfies $(\mathcal{L}_z - \mathcal{L}_w)K_k = 0$, and $K_k = \sum \omega_{\ell,a} S^a Z^\ell$ with $\omega_{0,a} = \mathbf{1}_{a=k}$ and $\omega_{\ell,a} = 0$ for $\ell + a > N$. The computation in the proof of [1, Lemma 3.2] gives

$$\frac{(\mathcal{L}_z - \mathcal{L}_w)S^a Z^\ell}{z - w} = S^a Z^\ell + \sum_{p \geq 0} \binom{a}{p} S^{a-p} Z^\ell \Big(\varphi_p(\ell)(\chi_{p-2} - \chi_p) + \psi_p(\ell)(\chi_{p-1} - \chi_p) \Big),$$

with $\chi_{-2} = -Z^{-1}$ and $\chi_{-1} = 0$. Collecting terms as there, with $W_{p,q}$ formed from φ and $W^\psi_{p,q}$ from ψ, gives

$$\begin{aligned} c_{\ell+1}\omega_{\ell+1,a} = a_{\ell+a}\,\omega_{\ell,a} + \sum_{j \geq 0} (-1)^j \Big(& A^\psi_j(\ell - j, a + 2j + 1)\,\omega_{\ell-j,a+2j+1} + B_j(\ell - j, a + 2j + 2)\,\omega_{\ell-j,a+2j+2} \\ & + \big(C_j + C^\psi_j\big)(\ell - j - 1, a + 2j + 2)\,\omega_{\ell-j-1,a+2j+2} \Big), \end{aligned}$$

where $A^\psi_j = W^\psi_{2j+1,j}$, $C^\psi_j = W^\psi_{2j+2,j+1}$, and $B_j = W_{2j+2,j}$, $C_j = W_{2j+2,j+1}$. The straight weight is $1 - c_{\ell+a} - b_{\ell+a} = a_{\ell+a}$, extended polynomially beyond N, and $\beta_0 = 0$. Up to this point no hypothesis of the theorem has been used: the recurrence holds for every array in the stochastic normalization. Under the hypotheses, all weights are nonnegative on Ω.

For $j \geq 1$, $0 \leq \ell \leq N - 1$ and $a \geq 0$, the following detour inequalities hold, with weights having a negative second argument interpreted as zero:

$$\begin{aligned} A^\psi_0(\ell, a) B_{j-1}(\ell + 1, a - 1) + B_0(\ell, a) A^\psi_{j-1}(\ell + 1, a - 2) &\geq 4c_{\ell+1} A^\psi_j(\ell, a), \\ B_0(\ell, a) B_{j-1}(\ell + 1, a - 2) &\geq 4c_{\ell+1} B_j(\ell, a), \\ B_0(\ell, a)\big(C_{j-1} + C^\psi_{j-1}\big)(\ell + 1, a - 2) &\geq 4c_{\ell+1}\big(C_j + C^\psi_j\big)(\ell, a). \end{aligned}$$

The proof of [1, Lemma 3.4] applies, with the lower bounds $A^\psi_0(\ell, a) \geq a\psi_1(\ell)$ and $B_0(\ell, a) \geq \binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(\ell)$. Lemma 2.1 for φ handles the products $\varphi_2(\ell)\varphi_n(\ell + 1)$. The two hypotheses of the theorem handle $\psi_1(\ell)\varphi_n(\ell + 1)$ for $n \geq 2$ and $\varphi_2(\ell)\psi_n(\ell + 1)$ for $n \geq 1$, which are the indices that occur. The moves C_j and C^ψ_j have the same displacement and are treated as one move. With this, the proof of [1, Theorem 3.1] gives $\omega \geq 0$, hence $L^k_{mn} \geq 0$ and $g(m, n; k) = L^k_{mn} e_k / (e_m e_n) \geq 0$. ∎

Proof of Corollary 3.2. Set $w_0 = w_1$; since $\kappa_0 = 0$, this leaves $\beta_0 = 0$. Fix ℓ and write $G_i = \varphi_i(\ell)$, $H_i = \psi_i(\ell)$ and $u_x = \binom{\ell}{x-i}$. For $i \geq 0$,

$$H_i G_{i+1} - H_{i+1} G_i = \sum_{x,y \geq i} u_x u_y \kappa_x \kappa_{y+1} (w_x - w_{y+1}).$$

Terms with $x \leq y$ are nonnegative, and terms with $x = y + 1$ vanish. The map $(x, y) \mapsto (y + 1, x - 1)$ is a bijection from the terms with $x \geq y + 2$ onto those with $i + 1 \leq x \leq y$; the remaining terms have $x = i$. A term and its image sum to $\kappa_x \kappa_{y+1}(w_{y+1} - w_x)(u_{y+1}u_{x-1} - u_x u_y) \geq 0$, because w is nonincreasing and the zero-extended binomial coefficients are log-concave. Hence $H_{i+1}G_i \leq H_i G_{i+1}$.

Since the support of (G_i) is an interval and $\beta_k = 0$ where $\kappa_k = 0$, chaining gives $H_{n+1}G_1 \leq H_1 G_{n+1}$, $H_{n+2}G_n \leq H_n G_{n+2}$ and $H_{n+2}G_{n+1} \leq H_{n+1}G_{n+2}$. Lemma 2.1 with

$(i,l) = (1,n)$ and $(2,n)$ reads $G_1(G_n + G_{n+1}) \geq CG_{n+1}$ and $G_2(G_n + G_{n+1}) \geq CG_{n+2}$, where $C = G_0 + G_1 = c_{\ell+1}$ and $G_n + G_{n+1} = \varphi_n(\ell+1)$. Since $G_1 \geq \kappa_1 > 0$, $H_1(G_n + G_{n+1}) \geq CH_1G_{n+1}/G_1 \geq CH_{n+1}$. If $G_{n+2} > 0$, then $G_2(H_n + H_{n+1}) \geq G_2H_{n+2}(G_n + G_{n+1})/G_{n+2} \geq CH_{n+2}$; if $G_{n+2} = 0$, then $H_{n+2} = 0$. These are the two hypotheses of Theorem 3.1. The case $i = 0$ of the first display, with $\beta_0 = \kappa_0 = 0$, reads $b_{\ell+1}c_\ell \leq b_\ell c_{\ell+1}$; for $1 \leq \ell < N$, division by $c_\ell c_{\ell+1} > 0$ shows that b_i/c_i is nonincreasing and $c_i/(b_i + c_i)$ is nondecreasing. If w is constant on the support of κ, then b is proportional to c, and with $d = b + c$ the array is that of [1, Theorem 3.1]. ■

For arrays that are quadratic in the index, concave diagonal coefficients are allowed.

Proposition 3.3 *(Quadratic arrays).* *Let $b_n = \beta_1 n + \beta_2\binom{n}{2}$ and $c_n = \kappa_1 n + \kappa_2\binom{n}{2}$ $(0 \leq n \leq N)$ define an array as above. If $\kappa_2 \geq 0$, $\kappa_2 + \beta_2 \geq 0$ and $b_0 \leq b_1 \leq \cdots \leq b_N$, then the system has nonnegative linearization.*

Proof. In the recurrence of the proof of Theorem 3.1, which holds for every array, $\varphi_n = \psi_n = 0$ for $n \geq 3$. So all moves with $j \geq 1$ vanish, and the moves with $j = 0$ have the weights $A_0^\psi(\ell,a) = \sum_{n\geq 1}\binom{a}{n}\psi_n(\ell) = b_{\ell+a} - b_\ell$, $B_0(\ell,a) = \binom{a}{2}\kappa_2$ and $(C_0 + C_0^\psi)(\ell,a) = \binom{a}{2}(\kappa_2 + \beta_2)$. These and the straight weights $a_{\ell+a}$ are nonnegative on Ω, so $\omega \geq 0$ by induction on ℓ, and $g(m,n;k) \geq 0$ as in the proof of Theorem 3.1. ■

With the linear profile $d_n = n/N$ and the ratio $c_n/d_n = r + \kappa n/N$ $(1 \leq n \leq N$, $r > 0$, $\kappa \geq 0)$, one has $\kappa_2 = 2\kappa/N^2$ and $\kappa_2 + \beta_2 = 0$ for $N \geq 2$. For $N = 1$, property (P) follows directly from $R_1^2 = c_1R_0 + b_1R_1$ when $b_1 \geq 0$. So every linearly increasing ratio with a linear profile and nondecreasing b has property (P); b is nondecreasing exactly when $\kappa \leq (1-r)N/(2N-1)$. Exact computations (`runs/varratio/quadratic.py`) show that each of the three hypotheses is needed: dropping any one of them gives quadratic arrays with a negative coefficient at $N \leq 3$.

4. Linearly and quadratically increasing ratios

For curved profiles, linearly increasing ratios need not satisfy the hypotheses of Theorem 3.1: the Newton coefficients of b of order at least 3 can be negative, and then some moves of even index in the recurrence of its proof have negative weight and no two-step detour. A resummation of the positive moves handles this.

Theorem 4.1 *(Linearly increasing ratio).* *Let $0 = d_0 < d_1 < \cdots < d_N = 1$ have Newton coefficients that are log-concave without internal zeros, let $0 < r \leq 1$ and $\kappa \geq 0$, and put $\rho_i = r + \kappa i/N$, $a_i = 1 - d_i$, $b_i = (1-\rho_i)d_i$ and $c_i = \rho_i d_i$. If b is nondecreasing, then the system has nonnegative linearization. The condition that b be nondecreasing is equivalent to $\kappa\big(N + d_{N-1}/(1-d_{N-1})\big) \leq N(1-r)$.*

For the linear profile $d_i = i/N$ the condition reads $\kappa \leq \frac{N}{2N-1}(1-r)$, and these are arrays of Proposition 3.3. For a convex profile $d_{N-1} \leq (N-1)/N$, so the admitted range of κ contains $[0, \frac{N}{2N-1}(1-r)]$. When $r < 1$, this containment is strict for a nonlinear

profile. For example, $N = 4$, $d_i = (2^i - 1)/15$, $r = 1/2$ and $\kappa = 2/5$ are admitted, with $b = (0, 2/75, 3/50, 7/75, 1/10)$, although $(2N-1)\kappa/N = 7/10 > 1 - r$.

Proof. Write $s = 1 - r$ and $t = \kappa/N$, and let $f_n(\ell) = \Delta^n d(\ell)$ and $\nu_i = \Delta^i d(0)$ be as in Section 2, with $\nu_{-1} = \nu_0 = 0$. For $0 \le i < N$ put $R_i = d_i/f_1(i)$; then $f_1(i) \ge \nu_1 > 0$, and log-concavity of $(f_n(i))_{n\ge 0}$ gives $R_{i+1} - R_i = \big(f_1(i)^2 - d_i f_2(i)\big)/\big(f_1(i)f_1(i+1)\big) \ge 0$. Since $b_{i+1} - b_i = f_1(i)\big(s - t(i+1) - tR_i\big)$ and the bracket is nonincreasing in i, b is nondecreasing exactly when its last increment is nonnegative, that is, when $t(N + R_{N-1}) \le s$ with $R_{N-1} = d_{N-1}/(1 - d_{N-1})$; this is the stated condition. In particular $tN \le s$. Since $c_i = (r + ti)d_i$ and $b_i = (s - ti)d_i$, the Leibniz rule for differences gives, for $\ell \ge 0$ and $1 \le n \le N - \ell$, which includes every index occurring in the moves on Ω,

$$\varphi_n(\ell) = (r + t(\ell + n))f_n(\ell) + tnf_{n-1}(\ell), \qquad \psi_n(\ell) = h_n(\ell) - v_n(\ell),$$

with $h_n(\ell) = (s - t(\ell + n))f_n(\ell)$ and $v_n(\ell) = tnf_{n-1}(\ell)$; both are nonnegative when $\ell + n \le N$. (Outside this range the formulas need not hold, because the Newton coefficients of b and c are set to zero beyond N.) Extend ν by zero outside $1 \le i \le N$ and put $\widehat{\kappa}_i = p_i\nu_i + q_i\nu_{i-1}$ $(i \ge 1)$, $\widehat{\kappa}_0 = 0$, with $p_i = r + ti$ and $q_i = ti$; the Newton sequence κ of c is the truncation of $\widehat{\kappa}$ at N. Then

$$\widehat{\kappa}_i^2 - \widehat{\kappa}_{i-1}\widehat{\kappa}_{i+1} = p_i^2(\nu_i^2 - \nu_{i-1}\nu_{i+1}) + q_i^2(\nu_{i-1}^2 - \nu_{i-2}\nu_i) + q_{i-1}p_{i+1}(\nu_i\nu_{i-1} - \nu_{i-2}\nu_{i+1}) + t^2(\nu_{i-1}\nu_{i+1} + \nu_{i-2}\nu_i + 2\nu_i\nu_i$$

and each term is nonnegative by log-concavity of ν. The positive support of $\widehat{\kappa}$ is that of ν when $t = 0$ and extends it by one index when $t > 0$, an interval in both cases. Truncation at N preserves log-concavity and interval support, so κ is log-concave without internal zeros, and Lemma 2.1 applies to f and to φ.

Moves. We use the recurrence of the proof of Theorem 3.1, which holds for every array. For $j \ge 1$ split $A_j^{\psi} = H_j - V_j$, where $H_j = W^h_{2j+1,j}$ and $V_j = W^v_{2j+1,j}$ are formed from h_n and v_n in place of ψ_n; both are nonnegative on Ω. Keep $A_0^{\psi}(\ell, a) = b_{\ell+a} - b_\ell$ as one move; it is nonnegative because b is nondecreasing. The weights B_j, formed from φ, and $C_j + C_j^{\psi} = W^f_{2j+2,j+1}$, formed from f, are nonnegative. Write $C'_j = C_j + C_j^{\psi}$.

Detours. All detour inequalities below are asserted for source nodes $(\ell, a) \in \Omega$; in the mixed products the occurring indices satisfy $n \le a - 2$, hence $\ell + n + 2 \le N$. Since $\varphi_2(\ell) \ge (r + t(\ell+1))f_2(\ell)$ and $c_{\ell+1} = (r + t(\ell+1))d_{\ell+1}$, Lemma 2.1 for f gives

$$\varphi_2(\ell)f_n(\ell+1) \ge c_{\ell+1}f_{n+2}(\ell), \quad \varphi_2(\ell)h_n(\ell+1) \ge c_{\ell+1}h_{n+2}(\ell), \quad \varphi_2(\ell)v_n(\ell+1) \ge \tfrac{n}{n+2}\,c_{\ell+1}v_{n+2}(\ell)\ (n \ge 2),$$

using $s - t(\ell + n + 1) \ge s - t(\ell + n + 2) \ge 0$ for the second and Lemma 2.1 with indices $(2, n-1)$ for the third. As in the proof of [1, Lemma 3.4], with $B_0(\ell, a) \ge \binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(\ell)$, for $0 \le \ell \le N - 1$ and second factors at $(\ell + 1, a - 2)$,

$$B_0B_{j-1} \ge 4c_{\ell+1}B_j\ (j \ge 1), \quad B_0H_{j-1} \ge 6c_{\ell+1}H_j\ (j \ge 2), \quad B_0V_{j-1} \ge 6c_{\ell+1}V_j\ (j \ge 2), \quad B_0C'_{j-1} \ge 6c_{\ell+1}C'_j\ (j$$

The first uses Lemma 2.1 for φ. The coefficient ratios are, on $m \ge 2j + 2$, $2j + 1$, $2j + 1$ and $2j + 2$ respectively,

$$\frac{jm(m-1)}{2(m-j-2)}, \qquad \frac{jm(m-1)}{2(m-j-1)}, \qquad \frac{j(m-1)(m-2)}{2(m-j-1)}, \qquad \frac{(j+1)m(m-1)}{2(m-j-1)};$$

they increase with j and are at least 5, 10, 6 and 6. Finally,

$$A_0^{\psi}(\ell,a)B_0(\ell+1,a-1)+B_0(\ell,a)A_0^{\psi}(\ell+1,a-2)\;\ge\;c_{\ell+1}\big(4H_1(\ell,a)-2V_1(\ell,a)\big). \quad (4.1)$$

Only $a\ge 3$ needs proof. Put $u_n=f_n(\ell)$, $y_n=\binom{a}{n}u_n$, $D=u_0+u_1=d_{\ell+1}$, $\alpha=s-t(\ell+a)$, $X=\sum_{n\ge1}y_n$, $Y=\sum_{n\ge2}y_n$, $X'=\sum_{j\ge1}\binom{a-2}{j}(u_j+u_{j+1})$, $Y'=\sum_{j\ge2}\binom{a-1}{j}(u_j+u_{j+1})$ and $J=\sum_{n=2}^{a-1}\binom{a-1}{n}u_n$, so that $X=au_1+Y$, $X'=(a-2)u_1+J$ and $Y'=Y-(a-1)u_2$. Then $A_0^{\psi}(\ell,a)=\alpha X-tau_0$ and $A_0^{\psi}(\ell+1,a-2)=(\alpha+t)X'-t(a-2)D$; both are nonnegative, and the two weights B_0 are at least $(r+t(\ell+1))Y'$ and $(r+t(\ell+1))Y$. With $H_*=\sum_{n\ge3}(n-2)y_n$ and $T=\sum_{n\ge2}(n-3)(a-n)y_n$ one has $H_1=\sum_{n\ge3}(n-2)(\alpha+t(a-n))y_n$ and, after a shift of index, $V_1=t\sum_{n\ge2}(n-1)(a-n)y_n$, so $4H_1-2V_1=4\alpha H_*+2tT$. Since $c_{\ell+1}=(r+t(\ell+1))D$, it suffices to show

$$(\alpha X-tau_0)Y'+Y\big((\alpha+t)X'-t(a-2)D\big)\;\ge\;D(4\alpha H_*+2tT). \quad (4.2)$$

The coefficient of α in the difference of the two sides is $K=XY'+YX'-4DH_*$. By Lemma 2.1, $u_i(u_j+u_{j+1})\ge Du_{i+j}$ for $i,j\ge1$, so $XY'\ge au_1Y'\ge D\sum_{n\ge3}ny_n$ and $YX'\ge\binom{a}{2}u_2X'\ge D\sum_{n\ge3}\binom{n}{2}y_n$; hence $K\ge\frac{D}{2}\sum_{n\ge3}\big((n-3)(n-4)+4\big)y_n\ge0$, and (4.2) holds when $t=0$. Let $t>0$. Monotonicity of b at $\ell+a-1$ gives $\alpha\ge tR_{\ell+a-1}\ge tR_\ell=tu_0/u_1$, so it suffices to prove (4.2) at $\alpha=tu_0/u_1$. Both sides are homogeneous of degree two in (u_n); take $u_1=1$ and write $z=u_0$ and $q=u_2$. If $q=0$, then $u_n=0$ for $n\ge2$ and both sides vanish. Otherwise $0\le z\le 1/q$ by log-concavity. At $\alpha=tz$ the two weights A_0^{ψ} are tzY and $t(z+1)J$, and (4.2) divided by t reads $F(z)\ge0$, where

$$F(z)\;=\;zYY'+(z+1)YJ-(z+1)(4zH_*+2T)\;=\;(1-qz)F(0)+qzF(1/q)+4H_*z(1/q-z),$$

the second form holding because F is quadratic with leading coefficient $-4H_*$. It remains to show $F(0)\ge0$ and $F(1/q)\ge0$. Put $L_3=\frac{3}{2}$, $L_n=\frac{n(n+2)}{6}$ for $n\ge4$, and $E_n=\frac{2(n^2-5)}{n+1}$. In YJ keep, for each n, the product with indices $(2,2)$ if $n=3$, and the products with indices $(2,n-1)$ and $(3,n-2)$ if $n\ge4$; by log-concavity with $u_1=1$, $u_iu_{n+1-i}\ge u_n$, and $\binom{a-1}{j}\ge\binom{a-i}{j}$, so $YJ\ge\sum_{n=3}^{a-1}L_n(a-n)y_n$. In Y keep the term $\binom{a}{2}q$; as $q(u_{n-1}+u_n)\ge(q+1)u_n$ for $n\ge3$, $YY'\ge(q+1)\sum_{n=3}^{a}\frac{n(a-1)}{2}y_n$. Since $L_n\ge2(n-3)$,

$$F(0)\;=\;YJ-2T\;\ge\;2(a-2)y_2+\sum_{n=3}^{a-1}\big(L_n-2(n-3)\big)(a-n)y_n\;\ge\;0.$$

Using $u_n\le qu_{n-1}$ and a shift of index, $\frac{4}{q}H_*+2T\le\sum_{n=2}^{a-1}E_n(a-n)y_n$, where $E_2<0$. As $L_n+\frac{n}{2}\ge E_n$ for $n\ge3$,

$$\frac{F(1/q)}{1+1/q}\;=\;YJ+\frac{YY'}{q+1}-\frac{4}{q}H_*-2T\;\ge\;\sum_{n=3}^{a-1}\Big(L_n+\frac{n}{2}-E_n\Big)(a-n)y_n\;\ge\;0.$$

The numerical facts used are $L_3=\frac{3}{2}\ge0$, $L_3+\frac{3}{2}=3\ge E_3=2$, and, for $n\ge4$, $6(L_n-2(n-3))=(n-5)^2+11$ and $6(n+1)(L_n+\frac{n}{2}-E_n)=n^3-6n^2+5n+60>0$.

Resummation. Regard the moves as operators on functions on Ω, each divided by c at the destination level; all strictly raise ℓ, and inequalities between operators are entrywise.

Let P and Q be the sums of the B_j with j even and odd, $C = C_+ - C_-$ with $C_\pm$ the sums of the C'_j with j even and odd, H_+ and H_- the sums of the H_j with $j \ge 2$ even and $j \ge 3$ odd, V_+ and V_- the sums of the V_j with j odd and $j \ge 2$ even, A_0 the operator of A_0^ψ, and U the straight moves. The recurrence reads $\omega = \beta + (U + P - Q + C + A)\omega$ with $A = A_0 + H_+ - H_- - H_1 + V_+ - V_-$ and $\beta = \omega|_{\ell=0} \ge 0$. The inequalities above give

$$P^2 \ge 4Q, \qquad H_+P \ge 6H_-, \qquad V_+P \ge 6V_-, \qquad C_+P \ge 6C_-, \qquad A_0P + PA_0 + 2V_1 \ge 4H_1.$$

Let $G = (I - P/2)^{-1} = \sum_{m=0}^{N} (P/2)^m \ge 0$. Then $PG = GP = 2(G - I)$ and $(I - P/6)G = \frac{2}{3}G + \frac{1}{3}I$, so $G(H_+ - H_-)G \ge GH_+(I - P/6)G \ge 0$, $GCG \ge 0$ and $G(V_+ - V_-)G \ge \frac{2}{3}GV_1G$. Hence

$$GAG \ge G\big(A_0 - H_1 + \tfrac{2}{3}V_1\big)G \ge G\big(A_0 - \tfrac{1}{4}(A_0P + PA_0) + \tfrac{1}{6}V_1\big)G = \tfrac{1}{2}(GA_0 + A_0G) + \tfrac{1}{6}GV_1G \ge 0.$$

With $R = U + P^2/4 - Q \ge 0$, the operator $M = G(R + C + A)G$ is nonnegative and strictly raises ℓ. Since $(I - P/2)^2\omega = \beta + (R + C + A)\omega$, the function $v = (I - P/2)\omega$ satisfies $v = G\beta + Mv$. Therefore $\omega = G\sum_{q=0}^{N} M^q G\beta \ge 0$, and $g(m, n; k) \ge 0$ as in the proof of Theorem 3.1. ∎

Theorem 4.2 *(Convex quadratic ratio).* *Let $0 = d_0 < d_1 < \cdots < d_N = 1$ have Newton coefficients that are log-concave without internal zeros, let $\rho(x) = r + tx + \tau\binom{x}{2}$ with $r > 0$ and $t, \tau \ge 0$, and put $a_i = 1 - d_i$, $b_i = (1 - \rho(i))d_i$ and $c_i = \rho(i)d_i$. If b is nondecreasing, then the system has nonnegative linearization.*

This contains Theorem 4.1 ($\tau = 0$). As in the proof of that theorem, $b_{i+1} - b_i = f_1(i)\big(1 - \rho(i+1) - (t + \tau i)R_i\big)$ with a nonincreasing bracket, so b is nondecreasing exactly when $t(N + R) + \tau\big(\binom{N}{2} + (N-1)R\big) \le 1 - r$ with $R = d_{N-1}/(1 - d_{N-1})$. The Newton coefficients of c need not be log-concave: for $d_i = i/4$ and $\rho(x) = \frac{1}{2} + \binom{x}{2}/40$ they are $(1/8, 1/80, 3/160, 0)$. The proof below replaces their log-concavity by a weighted detour inequality.

Proof. Write $f_n(\ell) = \Delta^n d(\ell)$, $\Delta\rho(x) = t + \tau x$ and $R_i = d_i/f_1(i)$, which is nondecreasing as in the proof of Theorem 4.1. Since $b_{i+1} - b_i = f_1(i)\big(1 - \rho(i+1) - \Delta\rho(i)R_i\big)$ and b is nondecreasing, $1 - \rho(m+1) \ge \Delta\rho(m)R_m$ for $0 \le m < N$, and $\rho(i) \le 1$ for $i \le N$. For $\ell + n \le N$ the Leibniz rule gives, all at ℓ,

$$\varphi_n = \rho(\ell + n)f_n + n\Delta\rho(\ell + n - 1)f_{n-1} + \binom{n}{2}\tau f_{n-2}, \qquad \psi_n = h_n - v_n - w_n,$$

with $h_n = (1 - \rho(\ell + n))f_n$, $v_n = n\Delta\rho(\ell + n - 1)f_{n-1}$ and $w_n = \binom{n}{2}\tau f_{n-2}$; here φ_n, h_n, v_n and w_n are nonnegative, while ψ_n need not be.

Moves. In the recurrence of the proof of Theorem 3.1, keep $A_0^\psi = b_{\ell+a} - b_\ell \ge 0$ and split $A_j^\psi = H_j - V_j - W_j$ for $j \ge 1$, where H_j, V_j and W_j are $W_{2j+1,j}$ formed from h_n, v_n and w_n; the weights B_j, formed from φ, and $C'_j = C_j + C_j^\psi = W^f_{2j+2,j+1}$ are nonnegative. With the signs $(-1)^j$, the moves W_j behave like the V_j.

Detours of H, V, W and C'. All detours are asserted for sources $(\ell,a)\in\Omega$, with second factors at $(\ell+1,a-2)$, marked by a prime. Since $\varphi_2(\ell)\ge\rho(\ell+1)f_2(\ell)$ and $c_{\ell+1}=\rho(\ell+1)d_{\ell+1}$, Lemma 2.1 for f gives, for $n\le a-2$,

$$\varphi_2 f'_n\ge c_{\ell+1}f_{n+2},\quad \varphi_2 h'_n\ge c_{\ell+1}h_{n+2},\quad (n+1)(n+2)\varphi_2 v'_n\ge n^2c_{\ell+1}v_{n+2},\quad (n+1)(n+2)\varphi_2 w'_n\ge n(n-1)c_{\ell+1}$$

the last two for $n\ge3$. The second uses $1-\rho(\ell+n+1)\ge1-\rho(\ell+n+2)\ge0$; the third uses Lemma 2.1 with indices $(2,n-1)$ and $(n+1)\Delta\rho(\ell+n)-n\Delta\rho(\ell+n+1)=t+\tau\ell\ge0$; the fourth uses indices $(2,n-2)$. As in the proof of [1, Lemma 3.4], with $B_0(\ell,a)\ge\binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(\ell)$ and $\binom{a}{2}\binom{a-2}{m-2}=\binom{a}{m}\binom{m}{2}$,

$$B_0H'_{j-1}\ge10c_{\ell+1}H_j,\qquad B_0V'_{j-1}\ge\tfrac92c_{\ell+1}V_j,\qquad B_0W'_{j-1}\ge3c_{\ell+1}W_j\quad(j\ge2),\qquad B_0\,C'_{j-1}(\ell+1,a-2)\ge6c_{\ell+1}$$

The coefficient ratios are $\frac{jm(m-1)}{2(m-j-1)}$, $\frac{j(m-2)^2}{2(m-j-1)}$ and $\frac{j(m-2)(m-3)}{2(m-j-1)}$ on $m\ge2j+1$, and $\frac{(j+1)m(m-1)}{2(m-j-1)}$ on $m\ge2j+2$; they increase with j, and at the smallest j the bounds are $(m-5)(m-6)\ge0$, $(m-5)(2m-7)\ge0$, $m\ge5$ and $(m-3)(m-4)\ge0$.

Detour of B. We show, for $n\ge2$ and $\ell+n+2\le N$,

$$(n+1)(n+2)\,\varphi_2(\ell)\varphi_n(\ell+1)\ge8(n-1)\,c_{\ell+1}\varphi_{n+2}(\ell).\tag{4.3}$$

Granting this, $B_0(\ell,a)\ge\binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(\ell)$, (4.3) with $n=m-2$, $\binom{a}{2}\binom{a-2}{m-2}=\binom{a}{m}\binom{m}{2}$ and $\binom{m}{2}\frac{8(m-3)}{m(m-1)}=4(m-3)$ give

$$B_0(\ell,a)B_{j-1}(\ell+1,a-2)\ge4c_{\ell+1}\sum_{m\ge2j+2}(m-3)\binom{m-j-3}{j-1}\binom{a}{m}\varphi_m(\ell)\ge4c_{\ell+1}B_j(\ell,a)$$

for $j\ge1$, because $(m-3)\binom{m-j-3}{j-1}-\binom{m-j-2}{j}=\binom{m-j-3}{j-1}\frac{(j-1)(m-2)}{j}\ge0$. (With constant 1 in place of $\frac{(n+1)(n+2)}{8(n-1)}$, (4.3) can fail: for $N=20$, $d_i=(2^i-1)/(2^{20}-1)$, $r=\frac12$, $t=0$, $\tau=10^{-3}$ one gets $\varphi_2(16)\varphi_2(17)<c_{17}\varphi_4(16)$.)

To prove (4.3), put $u_k=f_k(\ell)$, so that $f_k(\ell+1)=u_k+u_{k+1}$, and $p=\rho(\ell+1)$, $K_n=(n+1)(n+2)$, $L_n=8(n-1)$. Both sides are homogeneous of degree two in u; take $u_1=1$ and write $z=u_0$, $q=u_2$. By convexity and log-concavity, $0\le z\le\ell$ and $zq\le1$. If $q=0$ or $u_n=0$, then $\varphi_{n+2}(\ell)=0$. Otherwise put $y=u_{n+1}/u_n\in[0,q]$. Log-concavity gives $u_{n+2}\le y^2u_n$, and for $n\ge3$ also $u_{n-1}\ge u_n/q$ and $u_{n-2}\ge u_n/q^2$. Hence $\varphi_n(\ell+1)\ge u_n\mathcal{L}(y)$ and $\varphi_{n+2}(\ell)\le u_n\mathcal{T}(y)$, where

$$\mathcal{T}(y)=\rho(\ell+n+2)y^2+(n+2)\Delta\rho(\ell+n+1)y+\binom{n+2}{2}\tau,$$

$\mathcal{L}(y)=\rho(\ell+n+1)(1+y)+n\Delta\rho(\ell+n)(1+q^{-1})+\binom{n}{2}\tau(q^{-1}+q^{-2})$ for $n\ge3$, and $\mathcal{L}(y)=\rho(\ell+3)(1+y)+2\Delta\rho(\ell+2)(1+q^{-1})+\tau(z+1)q^{-1}$ for $n=2$ (exact). In both cases $\mathcal{L}(y)=A+By$ with $A\ge B\ge0$, so $\mathcal{L}(0)\ge\mathcal{L}(q)/(1+q)$; and $\mathcal{T}(q)\ge(1+q)\mathcal{T}(0)$ because $(n+2)\Delta\rho(\ell+n+1)\ge(n+2)(n+1)\tau$. The function $\mathcal{F}(y)=K_n\varphi_2(\ell)\mathcal{L}(y)-L_np(z+1)\mathcal{T}(y)$ is concave with $\mathcal{F}(0)\ge\mathcal{F}(q)/(1+q)$, so it suffices that $\mathcal{F}(q)\ge0$, which is (4.3) for the configuration $u_0=z$, $u_k=q^{k-1}$ $(k\ge1)$.

Next we reduce to $z = \min(\ell, 1/q)$. For $n \geq 3$, only $\varphi_2(\ell) = A_2 + \tau z$ and $c_{\ell+1} = p(z+1)$ depend on z, where $A_2 = \rho(\ell+2)q + 2\Delta\rho(\ell+1) \geq \tau$, so $\varphi_2(\ell)/(z+1)$ is nonincreasing in z. For $n = 2$, write also $\varphi_2(\ell+1) = G_2 + \tau(z+1)$ with $G_2 = \rho(\ell+3)q(1+q) + 2\Delta\rho(\ell+2)(1+q)$. For $z \leq Z \leq \ell$ the quotient $\varphi_2(\ell)\varphi_2(\ell+1)/(z+1)$ at z minus its value at Z equals $(Z-z)\big(G_2(A_2-\tau)/((z+1)(Z+1)) - \tau^2\big) \geq 0$, since $G_2(A_2-\tau) \geq 2(\ell+2)(2\ell+1)\tau^2 \geq (\ell+1)^2\tau^2$.

For the remaining configurations we use the following polynomial inequality. For an integer $n \geq 2$ and reals $h \geq 1$, $p, \tau \geq 0$ and $s \geq (h-1)\tau$, put $A = p + (2h-1)s + h^2\tau$, $B = p + nh(s+\tau) + \binom{n}{2}h^2\tau$ and $C = p + ((n+2)h-1)s + \binom{n+2}{2}h^2\tau$. Then

$$K_nAB - L_npC \geq 0. \tag{4.4}$$

Indeed, $K_nAB - L_npC$ is nondecreasing in s (its ps-coefficient is $a_n((n+2)h-1)$ with $a_n = n^2 - 5n + 10 > 0$, and its other s-dependent coefficients are nonnegative), and at $s = (h-1)\tau$ it equals $a_np^2 + C_n(h)p\tau + D_n(h)\tau^2$, where $C_n(h) = \frac{1}{2}\big(h^2U_n + h(10n^2+14n-60) + 2a_n\big)$, $U_n = n^4 - 4n^3 - 21n^2 + 12n + 60$ and $D_n(h) = \frac{1}{2}h^2n(n+1)^2(n+2)(3h^2-3h+1)$. For $n \geq 7$ all three coefficients are nonnegative, since $U_n = k^4 + 24k^3 + 189k^2 + 502k + 144$ with $k = n-7$. For $2 \leq n \leq 6$, $4a_nD_n - C_n^2$ is a polynomial in $v = h-1$ with positive coefficients:

n	v^0	v^1	v^2	v^3	v^4
2	576	2880	5616	4992	1664
3	1520	6240	9744	7200	2160
4	6300	27000	42660	30600	8604
5	25200	126000	229500	184800	56000
6	62720	376320	774144	677376	216576

so $a_np^2 + C_np\tau + D_n\tau^2 = a_n\big(p + \frac{C_n\tau}{2a_n}\big)^2 + \frac{4a_nD_n - C_n^2}{4a_n}\tau^2 \geq 0$.

If $1/q \leq \ell$, take $z = 1/q$, $h = 1 + 1/q$ and $s = t + \tau\ell \geq (h-1)\tau$. For the configuration above, $\mathcal{F}(q)$ divided by $q(1+q)$ equals $K_nAB - L_npC$, which is nonnegative by (4.4).

If $\ell < 1/q$, take $z = \ell$, and write $w = 1/q - \ell > 0$, $h_0 = \ell + 1$, $h = h_0 + w$ and $s = t + \tau\ell$. With $A(w) = p + (2h-1)s + \tau\big((\ell+2)h - \ell - 1\big)$ and $B(w)$, $C(w)$ as above (with this h), $\mathcal{F}(q)$ divided by q^2 equals $\mathcal{E}_n(w) = K_n(h_0+w)A(w)B(w) - L_nh_0pC(w)$ for $n \geq 3$, and $\mathcal{E}_2(w) - 12A(w)\tau w(\ell+w)^2$ for $n = 2$. At $w = 0$ both equal $h_0(K_nAB - L_npC)$ with $h = h_0$, which is nonnegative by (4.4). Expanding in w, with $\bar{A} = A(0) - p$ and $\bar{B} = B(0) - p$, every coefficient of w, w^2, w^3 and w^4 is a sum of nonnegative terms: for $n \geq 3$,

$$[w] = K_np^2 + p(a_1t + b_1\tau) + K_n\big(\bar{A}\bar{B} + h_0(\eta\bar{B} + \bar{A}\theta)\big),$$
$$[w^2] = p(a_2t + b_2\tau) + K_n\big(\eta\bar{B} + \bar{A}\theta + h_0(\eta\theta + \bar{A}\epsilon)\big), \qquad [w^3] = K_n\big(\eta\theta + A(0)\epsilon + h_0\eta\epsilon\big), \qquad [w^4] = K_n\eta\epsilon,$$

where $\eta = 2s + (\ell+2)\tau$, $\theta = n(s+\tau) + n(n-1)\tau h_0$, $\epsilon = \binom{n}{2}\tau$, $a_1 = (n+2)\big(2\ell(n^2 - n + 6) + 2n^2 - 3n + 11\big)$, $a_2 = K_n(n+2)$, $b_1 = \frac{n+2}{2}(\ell^2P_n + \ell Q_n + R_n)$ and $b_2 = \frac{K_n}{2}\big(3n(n-3)(\ell+1) + 14\ell + 12\big)$, with $P_n = 3k^3 + 15k^2 + 6k + 8$, $Q_n = 6k^3 + 30k^2 + 20k + 16$ and

$R_n = 3k^3+15k^2+16k+16$ for $k = n-3$; for $n = 2$ the coefficients of w, w^2 and w^3 are

$$12p^2+4(16\ell+13)pt+8(\ell+1)(2\ell+3)p\tau+48(\ell+1)(3\ell+2)t^2+12(36\ell^3+92\ell^2+76\ell+21)t\tau$$
$$+12(27\ell^4+93\ell^3+114\ell^2+62\ell+13)\tau^2,$$
$$48pt+12(2\ell+3)p\tau+24(6\ell+5)t^2+12(36\ell^2+67\ell+29)t\tau+12(27\ell^3+78\ell^2+67\ell+19)\tau^2,$$
$$12\big(2s+(\ell+2)\tau\big)\big(2t+(3\ell+5)\tau\big).$$

This proves (4.3).

Key inequality. We show, for $(\ell,a)\in\Omega$ with $a\ge 3$,

$$A_0^{\psi}(\ell,a)B_0(\ell+1,a-1)+B_0(\ell,a)A_0^{\psi}(\ell+1,a-2)\ \ge\ c_{\ell+1}\big(4H_1-2V_1-W_1\big)(\ell,a). \quad (4.5)$$

Use the notation of the proof of Theorem 4.1 ($u_n=f_n(\ell)$, y_n, D, X, Y, X', Y', J, H_*, T), and put $\alpha=1-\rho(\ell+a)$, $s=\Delta\rho(\ell+a-1)$, $p=\rho(\ell+1)$ and $Z=\sum_{n\ge2}\binom{a-n}{2}y_n$. Then $\alpha\ge sR_{\ell+a-1}\ge su_0/u_1$ and $s\ge\tau(a-1)$. Backward differences give

$$A_0^{\psi}(\ell,a)=\alpha X-sau_0+\tau\tbinom{a}{2}u_0,\qquad A_0^{\psi}(\ell+1,a-2)=(\alpha+s)X'-s(a-2)D+\tau\tbinom{a-1}{2}D,$$

both nonnegative, and $B_0(\ell,a)\ge pY$, $B_0(\ell+1,a-1)\ge pY'$, $c_{\ell+1}=pD$. Since $1-\rho(\ell+n)=\alpha+(a-n)s-\tau\binom{a-n}{2}$, reindexing gives $4H_1-2V_1=4\alpha H_*+2sT+4\tau Z$ and $W_1=\tau\sum_{n\ge1}n\binom{a-n}{2}y_n$. The argument of the proof of Theorem 4.1 with s in place of t, keeping the surplus of the two endpoints ($F(0)\ge 2(a-2)y_2$ and $F(1/q)\ge\frac23(1+1/q)(a-2)y_2$, from the term $n=2$ and $E_2=-\frac23$), shows

$$(\alpha X-sau_0)Y'+Y\big((\alpha+s)X'-s(a-2)D\big)-D(4\alpha H_*+2sT)\ \ge\ \tfrac23 sD(a-2)y_2$$

for $\alpha u_1\ge su_0$; the right side of this bound is linear in $z=u_0/u_1$ and is subtracted before the interpolation. With $s\ge\tau(a-1)$, the difference of the two sides of (4.5) divided by p is therefore at least

$$\tau\Big(\tbinom{a}{2}u_0Y'+D\Big[\tbinom{a-1}{2}y_1+\tfrac{(a-2)(a+11)}{6}y_2+(2a-5)y_3+\sum_{n\ge4}\Big(\tbinom{a-1}{2}+(n-4)\tbinom{a-n}{2}\Big)y_n\Big]\Big)\ \ge\ 0.$$

Resummation. With $W_\pm$ the sums of the W_j with j odd and $j\ge2$ even, the recurrence reads as in the proof of Theorem 4.1 with $A=A_0-H_1+(H_+-H_-)+(V_+-V_-)+(W_+-W_-)$, and the inequalities above give $P^2\ge4Q$, $H_+P\ge10H_-$, $V_+P\ge\frac92V_-$, $W_+P\ge3W_-$, $C_+P\ge6C_-$ and $A_0P+PA_0+2V_1+W_1\ge4H_1$. Since $(I-P/\mu)G=(1-\frac2\mu)G+\frac2\mu I$, one has $G(H_+-H_-)G\ge0$, $GCG\ge0$, $G(V_+-V_-)G\ge\frac59GV_1G$ and $G(W_+-W_-)G\ge\frac13GW_1G$, hence

$$GAG\ \ge\ G\big(A_0-\tfrac14(A_0P+PA_0)+\tfrac{1}{18}V_1+\tfrac{1}{12}W_1\big)G\ =\ \tfrac12(GA_0+A_0G)+\tfrac{1}{18}GV_1G+\tfrac{1}{12}GW_1G\ \ge\ 0.$$

With $U+P^2/4-Q\ge0$ this gives $M\ge0$, and (P) follows as before. ∎

5. Ratios of higher degree

For profiles of Newton degree at most two the ratio can have any degree, provided the Newton coefficients of c are nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros; no key inequality is needed.

Theorem 5.1 *(Low-degree profiles).* *Let $d_i = \nu_1 i + \nu_2 \binom{i}{2}$ with $\nu_1 > 0$, $\nu_2 \geq 0$ and $d_N = 1$, let $c_0 = 0$, and suppose that the Newton coefficients $\kappa_k = \Delta^k c(0)$, $1 \leq k \leq N$, are log-concave without internal zeros. Put $a_i = 1 - d_i$ and $b_i = d_i - c_i$. If b is nondecreasing, then the system has nonnegative linearization.*

Proof. We use the recurrence of the proof of Theorem 3.1, which holds for every array, with $\varphi_n(\ell) = \Delta^n c(\ell)$, $\psi_n(\ell) = \Delta^n b(\ell)$ and $f_n(\ell) = \Delta^n d(\ell)$ for the polynomial extensions. Since $f_n = 0$ for $n \geq 3$, every move A_j^ψ with $j \geq 1$, which involves only $n \geq 2j+1 \geq 3$, equals $-\widetilde{B}_j$ with $\widetilde{B}_j = W_{2j+1,j}$ formed from φ; the moves $C_j + C_j^\psi = W_{2j+2,j+1}^f$ vanish for $j \geq 1$, and $C_0 + C_0^\psi = \binom{a}{2}\nu_2 \geq 0$. The weight $A_0^\psi(\ell, a) = b_{\ell+a} - b_\ell$ is nonnegative on Ω, as are the straight weights and all B_j and $\widetilde{B}_j$, since $(\varphi_n(\ell))_n$ is obtained from (κ_k) by the shifts of Lemma 2.1 and is therefore nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros. Lemma 2.1 for φ gives, as in [1, Lemma 3.4], $B_0(\ell, a)B_{j-1}(\ell+1, a-2) \geq 4c_{\ell+1}B_j(\ell, a)$ for $j \geq 1$, and with $B_0(\ell, a) \geq \binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(\ell)$ also $B_0(\ell, a)\widetilde{B}_{j-1}(\ell+1, a-2) \geq 4c_{\ell+1}\widetilde{B}_j(\ell, a)$ for $j \geq 2$, because the coefficient quotients $jm(m-1)/(2(m-j-1))$ on $m \geq 2j+1$ are at least 10. In the resummation of the proof of Theorem 4.1 take $H = 0$ and $V_j = \widetilde{B}_j$; the key inequality is then trivial, and $M \geq 0$ gives (P). ∎

Corollary 5.2. *In Theorem 5.1 let $c_i = \rho(i)d_i$ with $\rho(x) = \sum_k \rho_k \binom{x}{k}$, where $(\rho_k)_{k\geq 0}$ is nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros and $\rho_0 > 0$. Then the Newton coefficients of c are log-concave without internal zeros. Hence every such ratio, of any degree, with nondecreasing b gives nonnegative linearization on these profiles.*

Proof. Put $s_k = \rho_k + \rho_{k-1}$ ($\rho_{-1} = 0$), which is log-concave without internal zeros, and $h = \nu_2/2$. The Leibniz rule gives $\kappa_k = ke_k$ for $k \geq 1$, with $e_k = (\nu_1 + h(k-1))s_k + h(k-1)s_{k-1}$. Write $\alpha = \nu_1 + h(k-1)$ and $\beta = h(k-1)$; then

$$\begin{aligned} e_k^2 - e_{k-1}e_{k+1} = {} & \alpha^2(s_k^2 - s_{k-1}s_{k+1}) + \beta^2(s_{k-1}^2 - s_{k-2}s_k) + (\beta - h)(\alpha + h)(s_{k-1}s_k - s_{k-2}s_{k+1}) \\ & + h^2(s_{k-1}s_{k+1} + s_{k-2}s_k + 2s_{k-1}s_k), \end{aligned}$$

and every term is nonnegative for $k \geq 2$ by log-concavity of s. So $\kappa_k^2 \geq k^2 e_{k-1}e_{k+1} \geq \kappa_{k-1}\kappa_{k+1}$. If $\kappa_k = 0$ with $k \geq 1$, then $s_k = 0$, so $\rho_k = 0$; as $\rho_0 > 0$ and ρ has no internal zeros, $\rho_m = 0$ for $m \geq k$, and $\kappa_{k+1} = 0$. ∎

For example, on the linear profile $d_i = i/N$ the exponential ratios $\rho(x) = r(1+\varepsilon)^x$ with $r > 0$ and $\varepsilon \geq 0$, whose Newton coefficients $r\varepsilon^k$ are geometric, give nonnegative linearization whenever b is nondecreasing. Nonnegativity of the ratio's Newton coefficients alone does not suffice: the cubic counterexample in Section 6 has the linear profile $d_i = i/4$ and the ratio with Newton coefficients $(\frac{19}{20}, 0, 0, \frac{1}{320})$, which are nonnegative and satisfy the log-concavity inequalities but have internal zeros. Theorem 4.2 and Corollary 5.2 are not comparable: the former admits convex quadratic ratios with $t^2 < r\tau$ on every log-concave Newton profile, the latter ratios of every degree on profiles of Newton degree at most two.

Products of Newton sequences. The proof of Corollary 5.2 used only that the Newton coefficients of $c = \rho d$ are log-concave. This holds for every profile.

Proposition 5.3 *(Products).* *Let $(\rho_i)_{i\ge 0}$ and $(\nu_j)_{j\ge 0}$ be nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros, extended by zero at negative indices, and let $f(x)=\sum_i \rho_i\binom{x}{i}$ and $g(x)=\sum_j \nu_j\binom{x}{j}$ for $x\in\mathbb{Z}_{\ge 0}$, where the sums are finite. Then the Newton coefficients $\kappa_k=\Delta^k(fg)(0)$ of fg are nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros.*

Proof. The product rule $\binom{x}{i}\binom{x}{j}=\sum_k \binom{k}{i}\binom{i}{k-j}\binom{x}{k}$ gives $\kappa_k=\sum_p H_k(p)\rho_{p_1}\nu_{p_2}$, where $H_k(i,j)=\binom{k}{i}\binom{i}{k-j}=[y^iw^j](y+w+yw)^k$ vanishes unless $i,j\le k\le i+j$. If either sequence vanishes identically, so does κ. Otherwise, if ρ and ν are supported on $[p_0,p_1]$ and $[q_0,q_1]$, with $p_1,q_1\le\infty$, then $\kappa_k>0$ exactly for $\max(p_0,q_0)\le k\le p_1+q_1$, so κ has no internal zeros. For log-concavity fix $k\ge 1$; then

$$\kappa_k^2-\kappa_{k-1}\kappa_{k+1}=\sum_{c\in\mathbb{Z}^2}\sum_{p\in\mathbb{Z}^2} T_c(p)\,u_c(p_1)\,w_c(p_2),\qquad T_c(p)=H_k(p)H_k(c-p)-H_{k-1}(p)H_{k+1}(c-p),$$

with $u_c(i)=\rho_i\rho_{c_1-i}$ and $w_c(j)=\nu_j\nu_{c_2-j}$. By log-concavity without internal zeros, u_c is symmetric about $c_1/2$ and nondecreasing on $i\le c_1/2$, so $u_c=\sum_{0\le a\le c_1/2}(u_c(a)-u_c(a-1))\mathbf{1}_{[a,c_1-a]}$ with nonnegative coefficients, and likewise w_c. It therefore suffices to show $D_c(B)=\sum_{p\in B}T_c(p)\ge 0$ for every box $B=[a,c_1-a]\times[b,c_2-b]$ with $a\le c_1/2$, $b\le c_2/2$.

Let $E=\{(1,0),(0,1),(1,1)\}$, so that $H_k=\sum_{e\in E}H_{k-1}(\cdot-e)$. Expanding $H_k(p)$, $H_k(c-p)$ and $H_{k+1}(c-p)$ in this way gives

$$D_c(B)=\sum_{e,e'\in E}\big(V_{e+e'}(B-e)-V_{e+e'}(B)\big),\qquad V_s(p)=H_{k-1}(p)H_{k-1}(c-s-p),$$

where $V_s(X)=\sum_{p\in X}V_s(p)$. Fix $s=e+e'$, write $V=V_s$, $m=c-s$, $t=k-1$ and $\mu=m/2$. With $n_1=2t-m_2$, $n_2=2t-m_1$, $n_3=m_1+m_2-2t$ one has $V(x,y)=\frac{t!^2}{n_1!n_2!n_3!}\binom{n_1}{t-y}\binom{n_2}{t-x}\binom{n_3}{x+y-t}$ (and $V=0$ if some $n_i<0$). Three properties follow.

(T1) For every interval W, the marginal $G_W(x)=\sum_{y\in W}V(x,y)$ is a constant times $\binom{n_2}{t-x}\sum_{z\in t-W}\binom{n_1}{z}\binom{n_3}{x-z}$, a product of a binomial row and a convolution of two log-concave sequences without internal zeros; so G_W is log-concave without internal zeros. The same holds with the roles of the coordinates exchanged.

(T2) $V(c-s-p)=V(p)$, and V is reverse regular of order two: $V(x,y)V(x',y')\le V(x,y')V(x',y)$ for $x\le x'$, $y\le y'$, by log-concavity of $\binom{n_3}{\cdot}$. Taking $x'=2\mu_1-x$ and y,y' symmetric about μ_2, central symmetry turns this into $V(x,y)^2\le V(x,y')^2$. Hence $V(x,y')\ge V(x,y)$ whenever $x\le\mu_1$, $y\le y'$ and $y+y'=2\mu_2$; and symmetrically in the coordinates.

(T3) If G is log-concave without internal zeros and $G(x)\le G(2\mu_1-x)$ for all $x\le\mu_1$, then G is nondecreasing on $x\le\mu_1$: otherwise $G(x-1)>G(x)$ for some $x\le\mu_1$, and log-concavity makes G nonincreasing from $x-1$ on, so $G(2\mu_1-x+1)\le G(x)<G(x-1)$.

Write $I=[a,c_1-a]$, $J=[b,c_2-b]$, $X(I',J')=V(I'\times J')$, and telescope along rows or columns. By the symmetry $H_k(i,j)=H_k(j,i)$ it suffices to treat five ordered pairs.

$e = e' = (1,0)$: $\mu = c/2 - (1,0)$ and $V(B-e) - V(B) = G_J(a-1) - G_J(a-2)$ by central symmetry. Since J is symmetric about μ_2, G_J is symmetric about μ_1, hence nondecreasing on $x \le \mu_1$ by (T1) and (T3); and $a - 1 \le \mu_1$.

$e = (1,0)$, $e' = (0,1)$: $\mu = (c - (1,1))/2$ and $V(B-e) - V(B) = V(a-1, c_2 - b) - V(a-1, b-1) \ge 0$ by (T2), since $a - 1 < \mu_1$ and $(c_2 - b) + (b-1) = 2\mu_2$.

$e = (1,0)$, $e' = (1,1)$: $\mu = c/2 - (1, \frac{1}{2})$ and

$$V(B-e) - V(B) = \big[V(a-1, c_2 - b) - V(a-1, b-1)\big] + \big[G_{J-1}(a-1) - G_{J-1}(a-2)\big].$$

The first bracket is nonnegative by (T2), as $a - 1 \le \mu_1$. For the second, $G_{J-1}(2\mu_1 - x) - G_{J-1}(x) = V(x, c_2 - b) - V(x, b-1) \ge 0$ for $x \le \mu_1$ by (T2), so (T1) and (T3) apply.

$e = (1,1)$, $e' = (1,0)$: the same V, and $V(B-e) - V(B) = \big[X(I-1, J-1) - X(I-1, J)\big] + \big[V(B - (1,0)) - V(B)\big]$. The first bracket vanishes by central symmetry, since $I - 1$ is symmetric about μ_1; the second is the previous case.

$e = e' = (1,1)$: $\mu = c/2 - (1,1)$ and $V(B-e) - V(B) = \big[K(b-1) - K(b-2)\big] + \big[X(a-1, J) - X(a-1, J-2)\big] + \big[G_{J-2}(a-1) - G_{J-2}(a-2)\big]$ with $K(y) = \sum_{x \in I-1} V(x, y)$. Since $I - 1$ is symmetric about μ_1, K is symmetric about μ_2 and nondecreasing on $y \le \mu_2$ by (T1) and (T3); and $b - 1 \le \mu_2$. The second bracket is $[V(a-1, c_2 - b) - V(a-1, b-2)] + [V(a-1, c_2 - b - 1) - V(a-1, b-1)]$, two differences of the form in (T2), since both pairs of second coordinates sum to $2\mu_2 = c_2 - 2$. For the third, $G_{J-2}(2\mu_1 - x) - G_{J-2}(x) = X(x, J) - X(x, J-2) \ge 0$ for $x \le \mu_1$ by (T2), so (T1) and (T3) give $G_{J-2}(a-1) \ge G_{J-2}(a-2)$.

Each of the nine ordered-step contributions $V_{e+e'}(B-e) - V_{e+e'}(B)$ is nonnegative, so $D_c(B) \ge 0$, which proves the proposition. (The individual $T_c(p)$ need not be nonnegative.) ∎

In the language of random sets: if S and T are independent random subsets of $[n]$ whose laws are invariant under permutations and whose cardinalities are ultra-log-concave of order n, then so is $|S \cup T|$, since $\Pr(|S \cup T| = k) = \binom{n}{k}\kappa_k$ for $\Pr(S = A) = \rho_{|A|}$ and $\Pr(T = A) = \nu_{|A|}$. This closure theorem is due to Walkup [4, Theorem 2], who proves that the double-binomial convolution $h_k = \sum_i \sum_r \binom{k}{i}\binom{i}{r}\rho_i \nu_{k-r}$, which is κ_k after the substitution $j = k - r$, preserves log-concavity; Proposition 5.3 expresses it in the Newton basis, and the proof above is self-contained. Hoggar's theorem is the analogue for the power basis. The diagnostics `runs/np/two_step.py` and `runs/np/case_proofs.py` check in exact arithmetic the identity for $D_c(B)$, the sign of each of its nine terms for $k \le 9$, and every bracket of the case analysis, (T1) and (T2) for $k \le 6$.

Log-concave ratios on log-concave profiles. Corollary 5.2 extends to every log-concave Newton profile. Besides Proposition 5.3, the proof uses a sign criterion for quadratic forms in log-concave sequences.

Lemma 5.4. *Let $Q(u) = \sum_{0 \le i \le j} q_{ij} u_i u_j$ with $q_{0j} \le 0$ for all j and $q_{ij} \ge 0$ for $2 \le i \le j$, and put $N_W(Q) = \sum_{i \le j,\, i+j=W} q_{ij}$. If $N_W(Q) \ge 0$ for every W, then $Q(u) \ge 0$ for every nonnegative sequence $(u_n)_{n \ge 0}$ that is log-concave without internal zeros.*

Proof. Fix W and put $p_i = u_i u_{W-i}$ for $0 \le i \le W/2$ and $p_{-1} = 0$. Log-concavity without internal zeros makes p nondecreasing. With $T_k = \sum_{k \le i \le W/2} q_{i,W-i}$ we get $\sum_{i \le W/2} q_{i,W-i} p_i = \sum_{k \le W/2} T_k (p_k - p_{k-1})$. Here $T_0 = N_W(Q) \ge 0$, $T_1 = N_W(Q) - q_{0W} \ge 0$, and $T_k \ge 0$ for $k \ge 2$. ∎

The weight sums are the coefficients of Q on geometric sequences: $Q(1, r, r^2, \dots) = \sum_W N_W(Q) r^W$. This Abel argument, with the reduction to the full sum when the negative terms come first, is that of Wang and Yeh [5, Lemma 2.1 and Corollary 2.6].

Theorem 5.5 *(Log-concave ratio).* *Let $0 = d_0 < d_1 < \cdots < d_N = 1$ have Newton coefficients that are log-concave without internal zeros. Let $\rho(x) = \sum_k \rho_k \binom{x}{k}$, where $(\rho_k)_{k \ge 0}$ is nonnegative and log-concave without internal zeros and $\rho_0 > 0$. Put $a_i = 1 - d_i$, $b_i = (1 - \rho(i)) d_i$ and $c_i = \rho(i) d_i$. If b is nondecreasing, then the system has nonnegative linearization.*

This contains Theorem 4.1 and Corollary 5.2. It also contains the case $t^2 \ge r\tau$ of Theorem 4.2. The exponential ratios $\rho(x) = r(1+\varepsilon)^x$ are admitted on every log-concave Newton profile. The proof is computer-assisted in two places, both by exact rational arithmetic:

- the signs of finitely many explicit polynomials in the weight-sum certificates of step (vi);
- the key inequality (5.2) for windows $a \le 5$, where step (vii) uses exact linear-programming certificates.

Proof. Setup. Only $\rho_0, \dots, \rho_N$ enter, and truncating (ρ_k) after index N keeps it log-concave without internal zeros, so we may assume it finitely supported. Write $f_n(\ell) = \Delta^n d(\ell)$, $R_i = d_i / f_1(i)$, which is nondecreasing as in the proof of Theorem 4.1, and $P_k(x) = \Delta^k \rho(x) = \sum_h \binom{x}{h} \rho_{k+h}$. As in the proof of Theorem 4.2, $1 - \rho(m+1) \ge \Delta\rho(m) R_m$ for $0 \le m < N$, and $0 < \rho_0 \le \rho(i) \le 1$ for $i \le N$; ρ is nondecreasing.

For every integer $x \ge 0$, the sequence $(P_k(x))_k$ arises from (ρ_k) by the shifts of Lemma 2.1, so it is log-concave without internal zeros. Since $\rho(x+1)^2 - \rho(x)\rho(x+2) = P_1(x)^2 - P_0(x)P_2(x) \ge 0$, the positive sequence $(\rho(n))_{n \ge 0}$ is log-concave. (The function $x \mapsto \rho(x)$ of a real variable need not be: $\rho(x) = 1 + x/2 + x^2/2$ has $(\log \rho)''(0) > 0$.) Log-concavity in k gives $\rho(y) P_{k+1}(y) \le P_1(y) P_k(y)$. Combining these facts, for integers $0 \le x \le y$ and $k \ge 1$,

$$\rho(x) P_{k-1}(y+1) \le \rho(x+1) P_{k-1}(y), \qquad \rho(x) P_k(y) \le \Delta\rho(x) P_{k-1}(y). \tag{5.1}$$

Indeed, log-concavity of $x \mapsto \rho(x)$ gives $\rho(x)\rho(y+1) \le \rho(x+1)\rho(y)$, equivalently $\rho(x) P_1(y) \le \Delta\rho(x)\rho(y)$. For the first inequality, $\rho(y) P_{k-1}(y+1) = \rho(y) P_{k-1}(y) + \rho(y) P_k(y) \le \rho(y+1) P_{k-1}(y)$; multiply by $\rho(x)$ and divide by $\rho(y) > 0$. For the second, $\rho(x)\rho(y) P_k(y) \le \rho(x) P_1(y) P_{k-1}(y) \le \Delta\rho(x)\rho(y) P_{k-1}(y)$. By Proposition 5.3, the Newton coefficients of $c = \rho d$ are log-concave without internal zeros, and so is $(\varphi_n(\ell))_n$ for every ℓ. For $\ell + n \le N$ the Leibniz rule gives, all at ℓ,

$$\varphi_n = \sum_{j=0}^{n} \binom{n}{j} P_j(\ell + n - j) f_{n-j}, \qquad \psi_n = h_n - v_n - \widehat{w}_n,$$

with $h_n = (1-\rho(\ell+n))f_n$, $v_n = n\Delta\rho(\ell+n-1)f_{n-1}$ and $\widehat{w}_n = \sum_{j=2}^{n} w_n^{(j)}$, where $w_n^{(j)} = \binom{n}{j}P_j(\ell+n-j)f_{n-j}$. Here φ_n, h_n, v_n, $w_n^{(j)}$ and $\widehat{w}_n$ are nonnegative, while ψ_n need not be.

Moves and detours. Split the moves as in the proof of Theorem 4.2, with W_j now formed from $\widehat{w}_n$. Lemma 2.1 for φ gives $B_0(\ell,a)B_{j-1}(\ell+1,a-2) \geq 4c_{\ell+1}B_j(\ell,a)$ for $j \geq 1$, as in [1, Lemma 3.4]. The detours of H and C', with constants 10 and 6, hold verbatim: they used only $\varphi_2(\ell) \geq \rho(\ell+1)f_2(\ell)$, Lemma 2.1 for f, and $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$ nondecreasing.

For V, the term $\rho(\ell+2)f_2$ of φ_2, the first inequality of (5.1) with $k=2$, $x=\ell+1$, $y=\ell+n$, and Lemma 2.1 for f with indices $(2,n-1)$ give

$$\varphi_2(\ell)v_n(\ell+1) \geq \tfrac{n}{n+2}\, c_{\ell+1}v_{n+2}(\ell).$$

For $\widehat{w}$, expand $\varphi_2(\ell) = \rho(\ell+2)f_2 + 2\Delta\rho(\ell+1)f_1 + P_2(\ell)f_0$, and pair its three terms with the components of $\widehat{w}_n(\ell+1)$:

- $\rho(\ell+2)f_2$ with component $i \leq n$, by the first inequality of (5.1) and indices $(2,n-i)$, gives at least $\binom{n}{i}\binom{n+2}{i}^{-1}c_{\ell+1}w_{n+2}^{(i)}(\ell)$;
- $2\Delta\rho(\ell+1)f_1$ with component $i \leq n$, by the second inequality of (5.1) and indices $(1,n-i)$, gives at least $2\binom{n}{i}\binom{n+2}{i+1}^{-1}c_{\ell+1}w_{n+2}^{(i+1)}(\ell)$;
- $P_2(\ell)f_0$ with component n gives at least $c_{\ell+1}w_{n+2}^{(n+2)}(\ell)$, since $P_2(\ell)P_n(\ell+1) \geq (P_0+P_1)(\ell)P_{n+2}(\ell)$ by log-concavity in k, and $f_0(\ell+1) = d_{\ell+1}$.

When $n-i=0$ the index condition is trivial. Collecting by target,

$$\varphi_2(\ell)\widehat{w}_n(\ell+1) \geq c_{\ell+1}\sum_{i=2}^{n+2}\theta_{n,i}w_{n+2}^{(i)}(\ell),$$

where $\theta_{n,2} = \binom{n}{2}\binom{n+2}{2}^{-1}$, $\theta_{n,i} = 1 - \frac{i(i-1)}{(n+1)(n+2)}$ for $3 \leq i \leq n$, $\theta_{n,n+1} = \frac{2}{n+2}$ and $\theta_{n,n+2} = 1$.

As in the proof of Theorem 4.2, the coefficient quotients are $\frac{j(m-1)(m-2)}{2(m-j-1)}$ for V, and $\theta_{m-2,i}\frac{jm(m-1)}{2(m-j-1)}$ for $\widehat{W}$, on $m \geq 2j+1$, $j \geq 2$. The first is at least 6, by $(m-4)(m-5) \geq 0$ at $j=2$. The second exceeds 2: it is at least $\frac{j(m-2)(m-3)}{2(m-j-1)} \geq m-2$ for $i=2$, at least $\frac{j(2m-3)}{m-j-1}$ for $3 \leq i \leq m-2$, equal to $\frac{j(m-1)}{m-j-1}$ for $i=m-1$, and at least 10 for $i=m$. Hence

$$B_0V'_{j-1} \geq 6c_{\ell+1}V_j \qquad \text{and} \qquad B_0W'_{j-1} \geq 2c_{\ell+1}W_j \qquad (j \geq 2).$$

Resummation. We prove below, for $(\ell,a) \in \Omega$ with $a \geq 3$,

$$A_0^{\psi}(\ell,a)B_0(\ell+1,a-1) + B_0(\ell,a)A_0^{\psi}(\ell+1,a-2) \geq c_{\ell+1}\big(4H_1 - 2V_1\big)(\ell,a). \tag{5.2}$$

With the notation of the proof of Theorem 4.2, the inequalities above give $P^2 \geq 4Q$, $H_+P \geq 10H_-$, $V_+P \geq 6V_-$, $W_+P \geq 2W_-$, $C_+P \geq 6C_-$ and $A_0P + PA_0 + 2V_1 \geq 4H_1$. Since $(I - P/\mu)G = (1-\frac{2}{\mu})G + \frac{2}{\mu}I$, one has $G(H_+ - H_-)G \geq 0$, $GCG \geq 0$, $G(W_+ - W_-)G \geq 0$ and $G(V_+ - V_-)G \geq \frac{2}{3}GV_1G$, so

$$GAG \geq G\big(A_0 - \tfrac{1}{4}(A_0P + PA_0) + \tfrac{1}{6}V_1\big)G = \tfrac{1}{2}(GA_0 + A_0G) + \tfrac{1}{6}GV_1G \geq 0,$$

and (P) follows as before.

Proof of (5.2): notation. Use the notation of the proof of Theorem 4.1: $u_n = f_n(\ell)$, which is log-concave without internal zeros, y_n, D, X, X', Y, Y', J, H_*. Put also $A = d_{\ell+a}$, $B = d_{\ell+a-1}$, $F = A - B = f_1(\ell+a-1)$, $X'' = B - d_\ell$ and $P_k = P_k(\ell)$. Since $c_{\ell+n} = d_{\ell+n}\sum_k \binom{n}{k}P_k$ for $n \le a$, the following are linear in P:

- $B_0(\ell,a) = \sum_k \beta_k P_k$ and $B_0(\ell+1,a-1) = \sum_k \beta'_k P_k$, where
  $\beta_0 = Y$, $\beta_1 = a(A-D)$, $\beta_k = \binom{a}{k}A$ $(k \ge 2)$,
  $\beta'_0 = Y'$, $\beta'_1 = aA - 2(a-1)d_{\ell+2} + (a-2)D$, $\beta'_2 = \binom{a}{2}A - (a-1)d_{\ell+2}$, $\beta'_k = \binom{a}{k}A$ $(k \ge 3)$;
- $c_{\ell+a} - c_\ell = \sum_k \chi_k P_k$ and $c_{\ell+a-1} - c_{\ell+1} = \sum_k \chi'_k P_k$;
- $c_{\ell+a} - c_{\ell+a-1} = \sum_k \delta_k P_k$ with $\delta_k = \binom{a}{k}F + \binom{a-1}{k-1}B$;
- $H_1 = H_* - \sum_k \zeta_k P_k$ with $\zeta_k = \sum_{n\ge3}(n-2)\binom{n}{k}y_n$, and $V_1 = \sum_k \nu_k P_k$ with $\nu_k = \sum_{n\ge3}(n-2)n\binom{n-1}{k-1}\binom{a}{n}u_{n-1}$;
- $c_{\ell+1} = D(P_0+P_1)$.

As $A_0^\psi(\ell,a) = X - (c_{\ell+a} - c_\ell)$ and $A_0^\psi(\ell+1,a-2) = X' - (c_{\ell+a-1} - c_{\ell+1})$, the difference of the two sides of (5.2) is $\mathrm{Key}(P) = \mathrm{Lin}(P) - \mathrm{Quad}(P)$. Here $\mathrm{Lin}(P) = \sum_k l_k P_k$ with $l_k = X\beta'_k + \beta_k X' - 4[k \le 1]DH_*$, and Quad is a quadratic form. We use repeatedly:

$$AX'' \ge (a-1)d_\ell F, \qquad AX' \ge (a-2)DF, \qquad u_0 F \le u_1 B, \qquad FD \le u_1 A. \tag{5.3}$$

The first two hold because $A/F \ge R_{\ell+a-1} \ge R_{\ell+i}$ gives $(A/F)f_1(\ell+i) \ge d_{\ell+i}$ for $i \le a-1$; summing over $0 \le i \le a-2$, respectively $1 \le i \le a-2$, gives them. The last two follow from $u_0u_{m+1} \le u_1u_m$, as $F = \sum_m \binom{a-1}{m}u_{m+1}$, $B = \sum_m \binom{a-1}{m}u_m$ and $D = u_0 + u_1$.

(i) Reduction to a quadratic form in P. By monotonicity of b at $\ell+a-1$, $\Delta c := c_{\ell+a} - c_{\ell+a-1} \le F$. With $\Phi(P) := \Delta c \cdot \mathrm{Lin}(P) - F\,\mathrm{Quad}(P)$ one has $\mathrm{Key} = (1 - \Delta c/F)\mathrm{Lin} + \Phi/F$, so it suffices that every $l_k \ge 0$ and $\Phi \ge 0$. With $\chi_k = \binom{a}{k}A - [k=0]d_\ell$ and $\chi'_k = \binom{a-1}{k}B - \binom{1}{k}D$, so that $E^1_m = X\delta_m - F\chi_m$, $E^2_m = X'\delta_m - F\chi'_m$ and $E^3_m = 2F\nu_m - 4(H_*\delta_m - F\zeta_m)$, expansion gives $\Phi(P) = \sum_{k,m} M_{k,m}P_kP_m$ with

$$M_{k,m} = \beta'_k E^1_m + \beta_k E^2_m + [k \le 1]D\,E^3_m,$$

and explicitly $E^1_0 = E^2_0 = E^3_0 = 0$ and, for $m \ge 1$,

$$E^1_m = \tbinom{a-1}{m-1}AX'' - \tbinom{a-1}{m}d_\ell F, \qquad E^2_m = \tbinom{a-1}{m-1}AX' - \Big(\tbinom{a-1}{m} - [m=1]\Big)DF,$$
$$E^3_m = 2F\nu_m - 4\tbinom{a-1}{m-1}BH_* - 4FZ_m, \qquad Z_m = \sum_{n\ge3}(n-2)\Big(\tbinom{a}{m} - \tbinom{n}{m}\Big)y_n.$$

Since (P_k) is log-concave without internal zeros, the Abel summation in the proof of Lemma 5.4, applied to every anti-diagonal of Φ, shows $\Phi \ge 0$ if every central sum $S_{\sigma,i} = \sum_{k=i}^{\sigma-i} M_{k,\sigma-k}$, $0 \le i \le \sigma/2$, is nonnegative. As $M_{k,0} = 0$, for $\sigma \ge 3$

$$S_{\sigma,0} = S_{\sigma,1} + M_{0,\sigma} \qquad \text{and} \qquad S_{\sigma,1} = S_{\sigma,2} + M_{1,\sigma-1} + M_{\sigma-1,1}.$$

Since $\binom{a-1}{m} = \frac{a-m}{m}\binom{a-1}{m-1}$ and $\frac{a-m}{m(a-1)} \le \frac{a-m}{m(a-2)} \le \frac{1}{2}$ for $m \ge 2$, (5.3) gives, for $m \ge 2$,

$$E^1_m \ge \tfrac{1}{2}\tbinom{a-1}{m-1}AX'' \ge 0 \qquad \text{and} \qquad E^2_m \ge \tfrac{1}{2}\tbinom{a-1}{m-1}AX' \ge 0.$$

Also every $\beta_k \ge 0$ and $\beta'_k \ge 0$; for β'_2 use $\binom{a}{2}A \ge (a-1)d_{\ell+2}$. Finally $E^1_1 = AX'' - (a-1)d_\ell F \ge 0$ and $E^2_1 = AX' - (a-2)DF \ge 0$.

(ii) The central sums with $i \ge 2$, and the coefficients l_k. For $k, m \ge 2$, $M_{k,m} = \beta'_k E^1_m + \beta_k E^2_m \ge 0$, so $S_{\sigma,i} \ge 0$ for $i \ge 2$. Next, $l_0 = K \ge 0$ by the proof of Theorem 4.1, and $l_k \ge 0$ for $k \ge 2$ termwise. By convexity, $A - D \ge (a-1)f_1(\ell+1) = (a-1)(d_{\ell+2} - D)$, so $\beta'_1 \ge (a-2)(A-D)$ and

$$l_1 \ge L := (A-D)\big((a-2)X + aX'\big) - 4DH_*.$$

(iii) The central sums with $\sigma \le 2$. Take $P = (P_0, P_1, 0, \dots)$ with $P_0 \ge 0$ and $P_1 > 0$, and put $\lambda = F/\Delta c(P)$. Then $\mathrm{Key}(\lambda P) = (\lambda/\Delta c)\Phi(P)$, and λP is the linear ratio $\tilde\rho(\ell + x) = \lambda(P_0 + P_1 x)$. Its $\tilde b = (1-\tilde\rho)d$ satisfies $\Delta\tilde b(\ell + a - 1) = 0$. So $\alpha := 1 - \tilde\rho(\ell + a) = tR_{\ell+a-1} \ge tu_0/u_1$ with $t = \lambda P_1$. For such α and t, the proof of Theorem 4.1 shows (4.2). Its two weights A^ψ_0 are nonnegative, since $X \ge au_1$ and $X' \ge (a-2)u_1$, and $B_0(\ell, a) \ge \tilde\rho(\ell+1)Y$, $B_0(\ell+1, a-1) \ge \tilde\rho(\ell+1)Y'$, since $\beta_1 \ge Y$ and $\beta'_1 \ge Y'$. Hence $\mathrm{Key}(\lambda P) \ge 0$, that is, $\Phi(P) = P_1(M_{0,1}P_0 + M_{1,1}P_1) \ge 0$. This gives $S_{1,0} = M_{0,1} \ge 0$ and $S_{2,1} = M_{1,1} \ge 0$. The sum $S_{2,0} = M_{0,2} + M_{1,1}$ is treated in (v).

(iii′) $M_{1,m} + M_{m,1} \ge 0$ for $m \ge 2$ and $a \ge 6$. Put $c'_m = \binom{a-1}{m-1}$. Then

$$M_{1,m} + M_{m,1} = \big[\beta_1 E^2_m - 4c'_m DBH_*\big] + \big[\beta'_1 E^1_m - DF(4Z_m - 2\nu_m)\big] + \beta'_m E^1_1 + \beta_m E^2_1,$$

and the last two terms are nonnegative.

- First bracket: $E^2_m \ge \frac{1}{2}c'_m AX'$ and $A \ge B$, so it is nonnegative if $R := a(A-D)X' - 8DH_* \ge 0$.
- Second bracket: $Z_m \le \binom{a}{m}H_* \le \frac{a}{2}c'_m H_*$, $\nu_m \ge 0$, $F \le A$, $E^1_m \ge \frac{1}{2}c'_m AX''$ and $\beta'_1 \ge (a-2)(A-D)$. So it is nonnegative if $R_2 := (a-2)(A-D)X'' - 4aDH_* \ge 0$.

(iv) $M_{0,s} \ge 0$ for $s \ge 3$. Put $c' = \binom{a-1}{s-1}$ and $c'' = \binom{a-1}{s}$. Then

$$M_{0,s} = Y'E^1_s + YE^2_s + DE^3_s = c'BK'' + FG_s,$$

where

$$K'' = Y'X'' + YX' - 4DH_*, \qquad G_s = c'(Y'X'' + YX') - c''(d_\ell Y' + DY) + D(2\nu_s - 4Z_s).$$

Note $u_1 = d_{\ell+1} - d_\ell > 0$. If $K'' \ge 0$, then $u_1 B \ge u_0 F$ gives $u_1 M_{0,s} \ge F(c'u_0 K'' + u_1 G_s)$, and

$$c'u_0K'' + u_1G_s = D\,Q_s + c''u_1^2Y', \qquad Q_s = c'(Y'X'' + YX') - 4c'u_0H_* + u_1(2\nu_s - 4Z_s) - c''u_1(Y + Y').$$

So $M_{0,s} \ge 0$ once $K'' \ge 0$ and $Q_s \ge 0$.

(v) $S_{2,0} \geq 0$ for $a \geq 5$. With $c'' = \binom{a-1}{2}$, the definitions give the identity

$$S_{2,0} = \beta_1' E_1^1 + \big[\beta_1 E_1^2 - c'' F(d_\ell Y' + DY)\big] + B\,K_a + F\,W,$$

where $K_a = (a-1)K'' - 4DH_*$ and $W = (a-1)(Y'X'' + YX') + D(2\nu_1 + 2\nu_2 - 4Z_1 - 4Z_2)$.

- Since $\beta_1 = a(X'+F)$, $E_1^2 = AX' - (a-2)DF$, $d_\ell \leq D$ and $FD \leq u_1 A$, the bracket is at least $A\Psi$, where $\Psi = a(A-D)J - c''u_1(Y+Y')$. Recall $J = X' - (a-2)u_1$ and $X' + F = A - D$.
- If $K_a \geq 0$, then $u_1(BK_a + FW) \geq F(u_0 K_a + u_1 W) = FD\widehat{Q}$, where $\widehat{Q} = (a-1)(Y'X'' + YX') - 4au_0H_* + u_1(2\nu_1 + 2\nu_2 - 4Z_1 - 4Z_2)$.

Hence $u_1 S_{2,0} \geq u_1\beta_1' E_1^1 + u_1 A\Psi + FD\widehat{Q} \geq 0$ once K_a, Ψ and $\widehat{Q}$ are nonnegative.

(vi) Weight sums. Steps (ii)–(v) reduce (5.2) to the nonnegativity of the quadratic forms L, R, R_2, K'', Q_s $(3 \leq s \leq a)$, K_a, Ψ and $\widehat{Q}$ in the sequence u. In each of them:

- the only negative coefficients come from multiples of u_0H_*, u_1H_*, u_1Z_s and $u_1(Y + Y')$, so they sit at index pairs $(0,j)$ and $(1,j)$;
- the positive parts X, X', X'', J, Y, Y' and $A - D$ contain no u_0.

So Lemma 5.4 applies, and it suffices that every weight sum be nonnegative. At $u_n = r^n$, with $p = 1 + r$, one has $d_{\ell+n} \mapsto p^n$. Hence

$$X \mapsto p^a - 1, \quad X' \mapsto p^{a-1} - p, \quad X'' \mapsto p^{a-1} - 1, \quad Y \mapsto p^a - 1 - ar, \quad H_* \mapsto arp^{a-1} - 2p^a + 2 + ar,$$

and $r\nu_s \mapsto sG^{(s)}$, $Z_s \mapsto \binom{a}{s}H_* - G^{(s)}$, where

$$G^{(s)} = \tbinom{a}{s}\big((s-2)r^s p^{a-s} + (a-s)r^{s+1}p^{a-s-1}\big) + [s = 1]ar.$$

Extracting $[r^W]$ from these products of powers of p and r gives each weight sum as a finite combination of binomial coefficients; for the forms other than L and for $W \geq 4$ it has the form $N_W = \pi\binom{2a-1}{W} + \binom{a}{W-1}\varrho(a,W)$, with $\pi > 0$ and ϱ rational, and $W = 3$ is treated directly (for Ψ it contains the extra term $\binom{a-1}{2}(a-1)$). For Q_s we bound $N_W(Q_s)/c'$ below, for $W \geq 4$, by its value with the nonnegative $G^{(s)}$-terms omitted and $s = 3$ in the two remaining s-dependent negative terms, whose magnitudes decrease as s grows. For $W = 3$,

$$N_3(Q_s) = c'\tfrac{(a-1)(a-2)(2a-3)}{6} + 6\tbinom{a}{3}[s = 3] - c''(a-1)^2,$$

which is $(a-1)(a-2)\big(\frac{a(a-1)}{12} + a\big)$ for $s = 3$ and at least $c'(a-1)\frac{a^2+a}{12}$ for $s \geq 4$. The certificates are as follows.

- For $W \geq a+2$, all negative terms vanish.
- For $6 \leq W \leq a+1$, bound $\binom{2a-1}{W}$ below by the Vandermonde terms $\binom{a}{k}\binom{a-1}{W-k}$ with $k \in \{W, W-1, W-2, W-3, 0, 1, 2\}$. These are distinct. Substituting $a = W - 1 + x$ and $W = 6 + y$, the cleared numerator of the resulting lower bound for $N_W/\binom{a}{W-1}$ is a polynomial in (x,y) with nonnegative coefficients.

- For $W \in \{3,4,5\}$, N_W is a polynomial in a whose coefficients are nonnegative after $a \mapsto a + a_0$. Here $a_0 = 5$ for K_a, $a_0 = 6$ for R_2, and $a_0 = 3$ otherwise.
- For $W \le 2$, the weight sums are 0 or positive.

The coefficient signs are verified in exact arithmetic by `runs/varratio/key_weight_cert.py`, which fails unless every certificate passes; `runs/varratio/key_weight_closed.py` checks the closed forms against the coefficient expansions for $5 \le a \le 30$. For L, the bound $\binom{2a}{W} \ge \binom{2a-1}{W}$ gives $N_W(L) \ge \frac{2(a-1)}{a} N_W(R) \ge 0$ for $W \ge 3$; also $N_2(L) = 2a(a-1)(a-2) > 0$, and $N_W(L) = 0$ for $W \le 1$.

(vii) Small windows. Steps (iii′) and (v) need $a \ge 6$ and $a \ge 5$. For $3 \le a \le 5$, every central sum $S_{\sigma,i}$, a cubic polynomial in u, and every l_k is certified nonnegative on log-concave u. The certificates are exact rational combinations of $u_k(u_{i+1}u_{j-1} - u_iu_j)$, respectively $u_{i+1}u_{j-1} - u_iu_j$ $(i+1 \le j-1)$, and monomials (`runs/varratio/key_phi_ustep.py`, `runs/varratio/key_lin_cert.py`; these cover all $a \le 10$). This proves (5.2) and the theorem. ∎

For cubic ratios, log-concavity of the Newton coefficients can be replaced by a single inequality.

Theorem 5.6 *(Cubic ratio).* *Let $0 = d_0 < d_1 < \cdots < d_N = 1$ have Newton coefficients that are log-concave without internal zeros, and let $\rho(x) = r + tx + \tau\binom{x}{2} + \sigma\binom{x}{3}$ with $r > 0$, $t, \tau, \sigma \ge 0$ and $r\sigma \le t\tau$. Put $a_i = 1 - d_i$, $b_i = (1 - \rho(i))d_i$ and $c_i = \rho(i)d_i$. If b is nondecreasing, then the system has nonnegative linearization.*

If (r,t,τ,σ) is log-concave without internal zeros, then $r\sigma \le t\tau$: for $t\tau > 0$ this follows from $t^2\tau^2 \ge r\tau \cdot t\sigma$, and otherwise $\sigma = 0$. Theorem 5.6 also admits cubic ratios with $t^2 < r\tau$ or $\tau^2 < t\sigma$, which Theorem 5.5 does not cover. The failing cubic examples of Section 6 violate $r\sigma \le t\tau$. The proof is computer-assisted: the inequalities (5.5), (5.6) and (5.4) and the inequalities $\Phi_2^{\mathrm{loc}}, \Phi_3^{\mathrm{loc}} \ge 0$ below are reduced to finitely many families of explicit polynomial inequalities, each certified in exact rational arithmetic by the nonnegativity of all coefficients.

Proof. Setup. As in the proof of Theorem 4.2, $R_i = d_i/f_1(i)$ is nondecreasing, $1 - \rho(m+1) \ge \Delta\rho(m) R_m$ for $0 \le m < N$, and ρ is nondecreasing with $0 < \rho(i) \le 1$ for $i \le N$; here $\Delta\rho(x) = t + \tau x + \sigma\binom{x}{2}$ and $\Delta^2\rho(x) = \tau + \sigma x$. For $\ell + n \le N$ the Leibniz rule gives, all at ℓ,

$$\varphi_n = \rho(\ell+n) f_n + n\Delta\rho(\ell+n-1) f_{n-1} + \tbinom{n}{2}\Delta^2\rho(\ell+n-2) f_{n-2} + \tbinom{n}{3}\sigma f_{n-3}.$$

Since $\binom{\ell+n-1}{2} = \binom{\ell}{2} + \ell(n-1) + \binom{n-1}{2}$ and $n\binom{n-1}{2} = \binom{n}{2}(n-2) = 3\binom{n}{3}$, this gives $\psi_n = h_n - v_n - e_n$ with $h_n = (1 - \rho(\ell+n)) f_n$,

$$v_n = n\Gamma_n(\ell) f_{n-1}, \quad \Gamma_n(\ell) = t + \tau(\ell+n-1) + \sigma\Big(\tbinom{\ell}{2} + \ell(n-1)\Big), \qquad e_n = \tbinom{n}{2}(\tau + \sigma\ell) f_{n-2} + \sigma\tbinom{n}{3}\big(3f_{n-1} + 3f_{n-$$

all nonnegative. Write $u_k = f_k(\ell)$, so that $f_k(\ell+1) = u_k + u_{k+1}$; then (u_k) is log-concave, and $u_0 \le \ell u_1$ by convexity.

Moves. Split the moves as in the proof of Theorem 4.2, with V_j formed from v_n and with a third family $E_j = W_{2j+1,j}$ formed from e_n in place of W_j.

Detours of H, V and C'. The detours of H and C' hold verbatim, with constants 10 and 6. For V,

$$(n+1)\Gamma_n(\ell+1) - n\Gamma_{n+2}(\ell) = t + \tau\ell + \sigma\Big(\tbinom{\ell}{2} + n^2 - 1\Big) \geq 0,$$

so Lemma 2.1 with indices $(2, n-1)$ gives $(n+1)(n+2)\varphi_2 v_n' \geq n^2 c_{\ell+1} v_{n+2}$ for $n \geq 3$, and $B_0 V_{j-1}' \geq \frac{9}{2} c_{\ell+1} V_j$ for $j \geq 2$ as before. (With the full σ-part $n\sigma\binom{\ell+n-1}{2} f_{n-1}$ in v_n, the corresponding difference is negative for $\ell < n+1$; without any σ-part in v_n, the reduction of the key inequality below fails for large ℓ.)

Detour of E. We show, for $n \geq 3$ and $\ell + n + 2 \leq N$,

$$(n+1)(n+2)\Big(\varphi_2(\ell) + \frac{n}{3}\varphi_3(\ell)\Big) e_n(\ell+1) \geq 3(n-1)\, c_{\ell+1} e_{n+2}(\ell). \tag{5.4}$$

Granting this, $B_0(\ell, a) \geq \binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(\ell) + \binom{a}{3}\varphi_3(\ell)$, $\binom{a}{3}\binom{a-2}{n} = \frac{a-2}{3}\binom{a}{2}\binom{a-2}{n}$ with $a - 2 \geq n$ whenever $\binom{a}{n+2} \neq 0$, and $\binom{a}{2}\binom{a-2}{n} = \binom{a}{n+2}\binom{n+2}{2}$ give, for $j \geq 2$,

$$B_0(\ell, a) E_{j-1}(\ell+1, a-2) \geq \tfrac{3}{2} c_{\ell+1} \sum_{m \geq 2j+1} (m-3)\tbinom{m-j-2}{j-1}\tbinom{a}{m} e_m(\ell) \geq 3 c_{\ell+1} E_j(\ell, a),$$

because $(m-3)\binom{m-j-2}{j-1} - 2\binom{m-j-1}{j} = \binom{m-j-2}{j-1}\frac{(j-2)(m-1)}{j} \geq 0$.

Detour of B. We show, for $n \geq 2$, $\ell + n + 2 \leq N$ and $(\ell, n) \neq (0, 2)$,

$$(n+1)(n+2)\,\varphi_2(\ell)\varphi_n(\ell+1) \geq 8(n-1)\, c_{\ell+1}\varphi_{n+2}(\ell), \tag{5.5}$$

and, if $N \geq 4$,

$$\big(12\varphi_2(0) + 8\varphi_3(0)\big)\varphi_2(1) \geq 8 c_1 \varphi_4(0). \tag{5.6}$$

Granting these, the argument after (4.3) gives $B_0(\ell, a) B_{j-1}(\ell+1, a-2) \geq 4 c_{\ell+1} B_j(\ell, a)$ for $j \geq 1$. The only exception is the term $m = 4$ for $\ell = 0$, $j = 1$. There $B_0(0, a) \geq \binom{a}{2}\varphi_2(0) + \binom{a}{3}\varphi_3(0)$, $\binom{a}{2}\binom{a-2}{2} = 6\binom{a}{4}$ and $\binom{a}{3}\binom{a-2}{2} = 2(a-2)\binom{a}{4} \geq 4\binom{a}{4}$ reduce the term to (5.6). Inequality (5.5) fails at $(\ell, n) = (0, 2)$ in general.

Proof of (5.5), (5.6) and (5.4).

- *Quadratic forms.* In each, the difference of the two sides is a quadratic form $\sum \kappa_{\beta\gamma}\rho_\beta\rho_\gamma$ in $(\rho_0, \rho_1, \rho_2, \rho_3) = (r, t, \tau, \sigma)$. Its coefficients are bilinear forms in the u_k, with coefficients polynomial in ℓ and n. By $r\sigma \leq t\tau$, the form is nonnegative if $\kappa_{t\tau} + \min(\kappa_{r\sigma}, 0) \geq 0$ and all coefficients other than $\kappa_{r\sigma}$ are nonnegative.

- *The quadratic part.* For (5.5) the coefficients $\kappa_{rr}, \kappa_{r\tau}, \kappa_{\tau\tau}$ need not be checked: the form with $t = \sigma = 0$ is (4.3) for the ratio $r + \tau\binom{x}{2}$. The left side of (5.6) exceeds that of (5.5) at $(0, 2)$ by $8\varphi_3(0)\varphi_2(1)$, a form with nonnegative coefficients. So only $\kappa_{t\sigma}$ requires a new check, made with $u_0 = 0$; the added quadratic form has nonnegative coefficients.

- *Reduction.* Divisions are first made for positive entries; zero tails, including $q = 0$, follow by continuity within the local log-concavity constraints, keeping $u_0 = 0$ when $\ell = 0$. Each remaining coefficient inequality is reduced as in the proof of (4.3). Take $u_1 = 1$, $q = u_2$ and $z = u_0 \in [0, \min(\ell, 1/q)]$, and for (5.4) also $x = u_3/u_2 \le q$, since φ_3 involves u_3; put $x = q$ for (5.5). The second factor involves $u_{n-3}, \dots, u_{n+2}$, respectively $u_{n-3}, \dots, u_{n+1}$ for (5.4). The two smallest indices carry nonnegative coefficients and the largest a nonpositive one.
  - Normalize the second block separately by $u_{n-1} = 1$. By log-concavity, $u_{n-2} \ge 1/x$ and $u_{n-3} \ge 1/x^2$, and $u_n = c \le x$, $u_{n+1} = cy$ and $u_{n+2} \le cy^2$ with $y \le c$ (for (5.4), $u_{n+1} \le c^2$). For (5.5), concavity in y leaves the branches $y = 0$, where each coefficient is affine in c, and $y = c$, where it is a cubic in c that is certified on the whole interval $0 \le c \le x$. For (5.4) the bound is a concave quadratic in c, so $c = 0$ and $c = x$ suffice.
  - In the exceptional low-index cases ($n \le 3$ for (5.5), $n \le 4$ for (5.4)), the reduction is done exactly in the free indices. For larger n the relaxed argument above remains valid where the index ranges of the two blocks overlap. Where u_0 occurs in both factors, a coefficient need not be affine in z; then z is written as $\zeta \min(\ell, 1/q)$ with $\zeta \in [0, 1]$.
- *Certificates.* The resulting polynomial inequalities are certified in three regimes: $z = 0$; $z = \ell$ with $q = 1/(\ell + w)$; and $z = 1/q$ with $\ell = 1/q + w$. In each regime all coefficients are nonnegative, in Bernstein form on $[0, 1]$ in c/q, x/q and ζ, with n symbolic above the overlap.
  - The scripts are `runs/cubic/bdetour_cert.py`, `runs/cubic/corner_cert.py` and `runs/cubic/edetour_cert.py`.
  - At $(\ell, n) = (0, 2)$ the endpoint value of $\kappa_{t\sigma}$ in (5.5) is $-8(q+1)(q^2-q-5)$. With the extra term of (5.6) it becomes $8(6q^4s^2 - 4q^3s^2 + 29q^3s + 11q^2s + 33q^2 + 36q + 11)$ with $s = x/q \in [0, 1]$, whose Bernstein coefficients in s have only nonnegative coefficients.

Key inequality. We show, for $(\ell, a) \in \Omega$ with $a \ge 3$,

$$A_0^{\psi}(\ell, a)B_0(\ell+1, a-1) + B_0(\ell, a)A_0^{\psi}(\ell+1, a-2) \ge c_{\ell+1}\big(4H_1 - 2V_1 - E_1\big)(\ell, a). \quad (5.7)$$

Use the notation of the proof of Theorem 4.1 (u_n, y_n, D, X, Y, X', Y', J, H_*, K), and put $\alpha = 1 - \rho(\ell + a)$, $s = \Delta\rho(\ell + a - 1)$ and $z = u_0/u_1$.

- *The parameter α.* We have $\alpha \ge sR_{\ell+a-1} \ge sz$. Every occurrence of 1 in the two sides lies in α, through $1 - \rho(\ell + n) = \alpha + \rho(\ell + a) - \rho(\ell + n)$. The coefficient of α in the difference of the two sides is $XB_0(\ell+1, a-1) + B_0(\ell, a)X' - 4c_{\ell+1}H_* \ge \rho(\ell+1)K \ge 0$. So it suffices to take $\alpha = sz$.
- *A quadratic form in ρ.* Then both sides are quadratic forms in (ρ_β), where $\rho = \sum_\beta \rho_\beta e_\beta$ and $e_\beta(x) = \binom{x}{\beta}$. Write $[e_\beta]$ for the contribution of a single basis ratio, and put $s_\beta = \Delta e_\beta(\ell + a - 1)$.

– By convexity of e_β, $A_0^\psi[e_\beta](\ell,a) \geq z s_\beta(X - a u_1) \geq 0$ and $A_0^\psi[e_\beta](\ell+1,a-2) \geq s_\beta D(X' - (a-2)u_1) \geq 0$.

– Moreover $B_0[e_\gamma](\ell,a) \geq e_\gamma(\ell+1)Y$, $B_0[e_\gamma](\ell+1,a-1) \geq e_\gamma(\ell+1)Y'$ and $c_{\ell+1}[e_\gamma] = e_\gamma(\ell+1)D$.

Hence the coefficient of $\rho_\beta\rho_\gamma$ in the difference is at least $e_\gamma(\ell+1)\Phi_\beta + e_\beta(\ell+1)\Phi_\gamma$ for $\beta \neq \gamma$, and at least $e_\beta(\ell+1)\Phi_\beta$ for $\beta = \gamma$. Here

$$\Phi_\beta = A_0^\psi[e_\beta](\ell,a)\, Y' + Y\, A_0^\psi[e_\beta](\ell+1,a-2) - D\,(4H_1 - 2V_1 - E_1)[e_\beta],$$

and $\Phi_0 = 0$. So (5.7) needs no condition linking r and σ, and it remains to show $\Phi_1, \Phi_2, \Phi_3 \geq 0$.

- *Local decomposition.* Expand in the local basis: $\binom{\ell+k}{2} = \binom{\ell}{2} + \ell k + \binom{k}{2}$ and $\binom{\ell+k}{3} = \binom{\ell}{3} + \binom{\ell}{2}k + \ell\binom{k}{2} + \binom{k}{3}$. With the splittings of Γ_n and e_n above, this gives

$$\Phi_2 = \ell\Phi_1 + \Phi_2^{\mathrm{loc}}, \qquad \Phi_3 = \tbinom{\ell}{2}\Phi_1 + \ell\Phi_2^{\mathrm{loc}} + \Phi_3^{\mathrm{loc}}.$$

Here $\Phi_\beta^{\mathrm{loc}}$ is Φ_β computed with $\rho(\ell+k)$ replaced by $\binom{k}{\beta}$. Its moves V_1 are formed with Γ_n replaced by $n-1$ for $\beta = 2$ and by 0 for $\beta = 3$, and its moves E_1 from $\binom{n}{2}f_{n-2}$, respectively $\binom{n}{3}(3f_{n-1} + 3f_{n-2} + f_{n-3})$.

- Φ_1 *and* Φ_2^{loc}. With $u_1 = 1$, Φ_1 is the function $F(z)$ of the proof of Theorem 4.1, which is nonnegative for $0 \leq z \leq 1/q$. Φ_2^{loc} is the τ-part of (4.5) with $s = a-1$, nonnegative for $0 \leq z \leq 1/q$ by the proof of Theorem 4.2.

- Φ_3^{loc}*: two endpoints.* Take $u_1 = 1$, $s = \binom{a-1}{2}$, $\kappa = \frac{s(2a-3)}{3}$ and $T_3 = \sum_{n\geq 3}(n-2)\big(\binom{a}{3} - \binom{n}{3}\big)y_n$. Since $E_1 \geq 0$,

$$\Phi_3^{\mathrm{loc}} \geq z\Big(sY + 2\tbinom{a}{3}\Big)Y' + (z+1)Y(sJ+\kappa) - 4(z+1)\big(szH_* + T_3\big).$$

The right side is concave in z, so the endpoints $z = 0$ and $z = 1/q$ suffice.

- Φ_3^{loc}*: coefficient bounds.* In YJ keep the products with indices $(2, n-1)$ for $n \geq 3$ and $(3, n-2)$ for $n \geq 4$, and use $u_i u_j \geq u_{i+j-1}$.

  – At $z = 0$, the coefficient of y_n ($n \geq 3$) is then at least

$$\kappa + s\Big(\frac{n(a-1)}{2} + [n \geq 4]\frac{(a-1)(a-2)n(n-1)}{6(a-n+1)}\Big) - 4(n-2)\Big(\tbinom{a}{3} - \tbinom{n}{3}\Big).$$

  – At $z = 1/q$, multiply by $q/(1+q)$. In $sYY'/(1+q)$ keep $\binom{a}{2}q$ from Y, and use $q(u_j + u_{j+1}) \geq (1+q)u_{j+1}$ and $u_n \leq q u_{n-1}$. The coefficient of y_2 is then $\kappa - \frac{2s(a-2)}{3} = \frac{s}{3}$, and that of y_n ($n \geq 3$) is at least the expression above plus $\frac{sn(a-1)}{2} - s\big(\frac{10(n+1)}{3} - 8\big)\frac{a-n}{n+1}$.

With $a = n+1+m$ and $n = 3$ or $n = 4+p$, the numerators of these bounds are polynomials in (m,p) with nonnegative coefficients (`runs/cubic/phi3loc_cert.py`); for $n = a$ the bounds are nonnegative directly. The same argument proves $\Phi_2^{\mathrm{loc}} \geq 0$ independently (`runs/cubic/phi2loc_cert.py`).

Resummation. Proceed as in the proof of Theorem 4.2, with E in place of W. The inequalities $P^2 \geq 4Q$, $H_+P \geq 10H_-$, $V_+P \geq \frac{9}{2}V_-$, $E_+P \geq 3E_-$, $C_+P \geq 6C_-$ and $A_0P + PA_0 + 2V_1 + E_1 \geq 4H_1$ give $GAG \geq \frac{1}{2}(GA_0 + A_0G) + \frac{1}{18}GV_1G + \frac{1}{12}GE_1G \geq 0$, and (P) follows. ∎

The condition $r\sigma \leq t\tau$ enters only through (5·5) and (5·4), each time through $\kappa_{t\tau} + \kappa_{r\sigma} \geq 0$. On geometric profiles at $(\ell, n) = (0, 3)$ one has $\kappa_{r\sigma} = -20q(4q^3 + 11q^2 + 9q + 1)$ and $\kappa_{t\tau} = 20(q+1)(8q^3 + 33q^2 + 30q + 6)$ in (5·5), so $\kappa_{t\tau}/|\kappa_{r\sigma}| \to 2$ as $q \to \infty$. This geometric family therefore obstructs the coefficientwise test for $r\sigma \leq u\,t\tau$ with $u > 2$; it does not establish a cutoff at $u = 1$. In fact the certificates for (5·5) and (5·4) also pass with $\kappa_{t\tau} + \frac{7}{4}\kappa_{r\sigma}$ in place of $\kappa_{t\tau} + \kappa_{r\sigma}$ (`runs/cubic/bdetour_u.py`, `runs/cubic/edetour_u.py`; the other coefficients and the key inequality do not involve the condition). Hence Theorem 5.6 holds with $r\sigma \leq \frac{7}{4}t\tau$ in place of $r\sigma \leq t\tau$. With $\frac{9}{5}$ the certificate for (5·5) fails. Exact diagnostics for this proof are listed in `papers/DIAGNOSTICS.md`.

6. Counterexamples and open problems

The criterion of [1] retains the full Krawtchouk range with a constant ratio b_i/c_i. Theorem 3.1 and Corollary 3.2 allow the ratio $c_i/(b_i + c_i)$ to increase, provided the Newton coefficients of b are those of c with nonincreasing weights, Proposition 3.3 covers linearly increasing ratios with a linear profile, and Theorem 4.1 covers linearly increasing ratios with log-concave Newton profiles and nondecreasing b,, Theorem 4.2 extends this to increasing convex quadratic ratios, and Theorems 5.5 and 5.6 to ratios of higher degree. Find direct inequalities that cover other varying ratios, for instance nonlinear increasing ratios, which Theorems 3.1 and 4.1 do not cover in general. Log-concavity of the Newton coefficients of both d and c together with monotone b does not suffice: $d = (0, 25, 55, 91)/91$, $c = (0, 24, 54, 90)/91$ gives $g(3, 3; 3) = -3/2002$. Increasing ratios with nondecreasing b can fail as well: for the linear profile $d_i = i/3$ and the concave ratio $\rho = (1/2, 3/4, 5/6)$, for which $b_i = 1/6$ for $i \geq 1$, one has $g(3, 3; 3) = -1/24$, and a convex kinked ratio on the linear profile fails at $N = 120$ [2]. Theorem 4.2 does not extend to cubic ratios: for $N = 4$, $d_i = i/4$ and $\rho(x) = \frac{19}{20} + \binom{x}{3}/320$, whose Newton coefficients $(\frac{19}{20}, 0, 0, \frac{1}{320})$ are nonnegative, $b = (0, \frac{1}{80}, \frac{1}{40}, \frac{9}{256}, \frac{3}{80})$ is nondecreasing, but $g(4, 4; 4) = -14011/30720000$. Even the bound $r \leq \frac{9}{10}$ does not restore (P) for cubic ratios: on linear profiles with $\kappa = 1/80$, which keeps b nondecreasing, $\rho_i = \frac{9}{10} + \kappa\binom{i}{3}/\binom{N}{3}$ gives $g(48, 48; 48) < 0$ for $N = 48$, and $\rho_i = \frac{9}{10} + \kappa(i/N)^3$ gives $g(64, 64; 63) < 0$ for $N = 64$. Steeper ratios fail at smaller r, again with nondecreasing b and nonnegative Newton coefficients of ρ: $\rho_i = \frac{1}{2} + 10^{i-N}/100$ gives $g(40, 40; 40) < 0$ for $N = 40$, and raising only the last ratio, $\rho_i = r$ for $i < N$ and $\rho_N = r + (1 - r)/N$, gives $g(40, 40; 38) < 0$ for $r = \frac{1}{2}$, $N = 40$ and $g(120, 120; 119) < 0$ for $r = \frac{2}{5}$, $N = 120$ (`runs/varratio/frontier_examples.py`). Write a cubic ratio as $\rho(x) = r + tx + \tau\binom{x}{2} + \sigma\binom{x}{3}$. The cubic examples above violate $r\sigma \leq t\tau$, a consequence of log-concavity without internal zeros of (r, t, τ, σ): in the first two $t = \tau = 0$, and for $\kappa(i/N)^3$ one has $t\tau = 6\kappa^2/N^6 < r\sigma = 6r\kappa/N^3$. In sampled arrays with $t, \tau \geq 0$, $r\sigma = u\,t\tau$ and nondecreasing b on log-concave Newton profiles, no negative coefficients were

found for the tested values $u \in \{\frac{1}{4}, 1, 4, 16, 64\}$, $r \in \{\frac{1}{10}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{4}{5}, \frac{19}{20}, \frac{99}{100}\}$ and $4 \le N \le 18$ (full tables), and in the coefficients $g(m, N; k)$ for $u \in \{1, 4, 16\}$ and $N = 24, 32, 48, 64, 96$ (`runs/varratio/cubic_lc_test.py`); in these samples the operator M of the proof of Theorem 4.1 was nonnegative for $u \le 4$ and $N \le 13$. For $t = \tau = 0$, by contrast, M has negative entries; for instance $N = 6$, $d_i = i/6$, $r = \frac{1}{5}$ and $\sigma = \frac{1}{200}$ give a negative entry (`runs/varratio/cubic_diag.py`). Theorem 5.6 and the remark after its proof show that $r\sigma \le u\, t\tau$ suffices for $u \le \frac{7}{4}$. Decide whether it suffices for larger u; the proof of Theorem 5.6 uses the condition only coefficientwise, and on geometric profiles that test fails for $u > 2$. Theorem 5.5 admits ratios with log-concave Newton coefficients, of any degree, on every log-concave Newton profile; its proof is computer-assisted. Find a proof of its key inequality (5.2) without computer certificates, and decide whether, for ratios of degree greater than three, log-concavity of the ratio's Newton coefficients can be weakened to conditions like the one in Theorem 5.6. The terminating row and products of degree sum greater than N must remain part of the conclusion.

AI-use disclosure

OpenAI Codex and Anthropic Claude were used to develop proof arguments, check source passages, construct exact-arithmetic diagnostics, draft and revise this manuscript, and prepare the Lean formalization. The resummation in the proof of Theorem 4.1, its key inequality under nondecreasing b, and the weighted detour and key inequality in the proof of Theorem 4.2 arose in research consultations with ChatGPT Pro; the exact checks were completed with Claude, which also prepared the Lean formalizations. Theorem 5.1, Corollary 5.2, Theorems 5.5 and 5.6 and Lemma 5.4 were found and proved with Claude, without research consultation; Proposition 5.3, which is due to Walkup, was rederived with Claude together with the self-contained proof given here. Every result was reviewed by ChatGPT Pro, as part of a longer manuscript (an AI review with independent exact checks, not human peer review); the review rounds and their corrections are recorded in `REVIEW.md`, and each returned PASS or PASS WITH MINOR FIXES, with the fixes applied. For Theorems 5.5 and 5.6 the reviewer reran transcribed copies of the certificate scripts; the scripts were also run unmodified from a fresh clone of the companion code at the cited revision, and all of them passed (`runs/verify/RESULTS.md`). The author set the research objective and retains responsibility for publication decisions and the final mathematical claims. No independent human verification is asserted here. "Machine-verified" refers only to the Lean theorems listed in the section on code and formalization; Theorems 5.5 and 5.6 are not machine-verified.

Code and formalization

The companion code [6] contains the certificate scripts cited in the proofs of Theorems 5.5 and 5.6, exact-arithmetic diagnostics for every result (`papers/DIAGNOSTICS.md`), and a Lean 4 development, built and audited by `make lean` and `make axioms`; the audit rejects dependencies outside `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`. The declarations below

have compiled proofs without added axioms or admitted goals. Notes on how each Lean statement matches the text are in `papers/FORMALIZATION.md`.

Result	Lean declaration
Theorem 3.1: varying ratio	`Szkraw.varyratio_matrix`
Corollary 3.2: nonincreasing weights	`Szkraw.varyratio_weights`
Proposition 3.3: quadratic arrays	`Szkraw.quadratic_matrix`
Theorem 4.1: linearly increasing ratio	`Szkraw.affine_matrix`, `Szkraw.affine_bmono_iff`
Remarks after Theorem 4.1	`Szkraw.affine_range_remarks`, `Szkraw.profile_last_le`, `Szkraw.affEx_remark`
Theorem 4.2: convex quadratic ratio	`Szkraw.quadratic_ratio_matrix`, `Szkraw.quadratic_bmono_iff`
Remarks on Theorem 4.2	`Szkraw.quadExample_remark`, `Szkraw.quadB_unit_fails`
Theorem 5.1: low-degree profiles	`Szkraw.lowdeg_matrix`
Corollary 5.2	`Szkraw.lowdeg_newton_lc`, `Szkraw.lowdeg_ratio_matrix`
Proposition 5.3: products of Newton sequences	`Szkraw.newton_product_LCNZ`
Lemma 5.4	`Szkraw.abel_weight`
Section 6: the counterexamples with $N = 3$ and the cubic counterexample with $N = 4$	`Szkraw.openEx1_fails`, `Szkraw.openEx2_fails`, `Szkraw.cubic_ratio_fails`

The Lean proof of Theorem 5.5 is in progress: its assembly from the key inequality (5.2) is formalized, the key inequality is not.

References

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[6] L. P. Polzer, *Companion code for finite nonnegative linearization* (2026), revision `4f739c3` (full identifier in the URL), https://github.com/skypher/szkraw/tree/4f739c3f127d51405a9eb150cf0ef9e4f678379e.